

ENGLISH FOR CUSTOMER PARTNERSHIPS

Customer Success English

Build adoption. Explain value. Keep trust.

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Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For customer success managers, onboarding specialists, implementation teams, account managers, and customer-facing leaders.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight customer conversations: agree a workable launch, interpret adoption, communicate an incident, validate value, plan a renewal, assess expansion, clarify a feature request, and repair a disputed expectation.

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Useful progress. Credible promises.

Customer success conversations connect the product to the work a customer needs to accomplish. These cases practice the language of shared ownership, meaningful use, measured outcomes, and honest follow-through when expectations or evidence are incomplete.

Agree the outcome before the activity

A completed training session or a high login count can be useful without proving that the customer has achieved the intended result. Name the workflow and the evidence that would demonstrate progress.

"Which completed task would show that the team can work independently?"

Give numbers a clear basis

State the period, population, unit, and source. Keep observed results separate from assumptions, and keep time released separate from cash savings.

"Thirty of eighty eligible users completed the workflow in the last thirty days."

Own the communication you can control

Acknowledge the impact, give the verified status, and name the next update. Do not fill an uncomfortable silence with an unsupported fix date or feature promise.

"I will update you at fourteen hundred UTC, even if the investigation is still open."

Keep the partnership two-sided

Confirm customer and supplier responsibilities without assigning blame. Ask permission to involve additional stakeholders, and set calm boundaries when frustration becomes personal.

"I want to resolve the issue with you; let us keep the discussion focused on the work."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All accounts, products, people, metrics, policies, dates, and incidents are fictional. This book teaches professional English, not technical, financial, legal, or security advice. Follow actual contracts, approved support guidance, data-handling rules, and authorized escalation procedures. Health-score definitions and renewal processes vary by organization.

Turn a hoped-for launch into a shared readiness plan

A Read the situation

Clarify owners, dependencies, and acceptance checks before confirming a customer launch date.

Customer lead Omar expects a launch on Friday, 9 October. The export owner and training slot are still unassigned. Customer success manager Lena cannot confirm readiness. The agreed launch conditions are an approved customer export, a successful test import, user acceptance of the main workflow, and completed administrator training. The customer owns data preparation; the supplier owns import mapping and training delivery. No one has yet confirmed that the required people are available. A readiness review is scheduled for Thursday at 15:00 UTC.

PEOPLE / Omar: Customer implementation lead | Lena: Customer success manager

A SHARED PLAN NEEDS EXPLICIT OWNERS

Customers may interpret a friendly agreement with a target as a promise. State what is agreed, what is still unassigned, and which conditions govern launch. Confirm responsibility without making the customer feel that the supplier is transferring every difficulty to them.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the status of the Friday launch?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A A target whose readiness conditions are not yet confirmed | B A completed acceptance milestone |
| C A confirmed date with all resources assigned | D A date canceled by the customer |

2. Who owns preparation of the customer data?

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|--|
| A The customer | B The supplier training team |
| C Any end user who logs in | D The account executive automatically |

3. When is the readiness review?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Thursday at 15:00 UTC | B Friday after launch at 15:00 UTC |
| C Thursday at 15:00 in an unspecified local zone | D Whenever training happens to finish |

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

onboarding

The process of preparing a customer to use a service effectively.

IN USE coordinate onboarding

implementation

Work to configure, connect, and introduce a solution.

IN USE plan the implementation

kickoff

The initial meeting aligning purpose, people, and approach.

IN USE run a kickoff

success plan

A shared record of outcomes, actions, ownership, and measures.

IN USE agree a success plan

target date

A desired date whose commitment status must be specified.

IN USE qualify the target date

go-live

The start of operational use under agreed conditions.

IN USE confirm go-live readiness

dependency

A task or condition on which another step relies.

IN USE identify dependencies

prerequisite

Something required before a particular activity can proceed.

IN USE verify prerequisites

data migration

Moving data between systems with appropriate checks.

IN USE coordinate data migration

source export

Data extracted from the originating system.

IN USE approve the source export

data mapping

Specifying how source fields correspond to destination fields.

IN USE validate data mapping

data owner

The role accountable for the relevant data and its use.

IN USE confirm the data owner

Precision check

A target date is not evidence of readiness. The four stated conditions are export approval, a successful test import, workflow acceptance, and administrator training. The Thursday review checks those conditions; holding the meeting alone does not satisfy them.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

test import

A controlled trial of bringing data into the destination.

IN USE complete a test import

UAT

User acceptance testing; users checking the solution against agreed needs.

IN USE schedule UAT

acceptance criterion

A defined condition used to judge whether work is acceptable.

IN USE agree acceptance criteria

administrator

A user with specified management permissions in the service.

IN USE train administrators

training slot

A scheduled period with the required trainer and participants.

IN USE confirm the training slot

readiness review

A check of whether the conditions for the next stage are met.

IN USE hold a readiness review

cutover

The coordinated transition into a new operational arrangement.

IN USE plan the cutover

rollback plan

An approved approach for reversing a change if required.

IN USE review the rollback plan

hypercare

A defined period of enhanced support after introduction.

IN USE define hypercare coverage

handover

Transfer of responsibility with the necessary information.

IN USE complete the handover

RACI

Responsible, accountable, consulted, and informed; a role-assignment framework.

IN USE clarify the RACI

open dependency

A required preceding task or condition not yet satisfied.

IN USE track open dependencies

Precision check

Data preparation and import mapping have different owners. The customer must approve appropriate source data, while the supplier maps the agreed fields. Secure transfer arrangements, access, and any rollback procedures must follow the actual implementation plan.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CONFIRM THE OBJECTIVE

"Which workflow must the team be able to complete on launch day?"

NAME A DEPENDENCY

"The test import depends on an approved customer export."

ASK FOR AN OWNER

"Who can own the export and confirm its availability?"

DEFINE ACCEPTANCE

"We need users to complete the agreed workflow successfully."

QUALIFY THE DATE

"Friday is the target, but readiness is not yet confirmed."

SEPARATE RESPONSIBILITIES

"Your team prepares the data; our team maps the agreed fields."

CHECK CAPACITY

"Has that person accepted the task and the timing?"

CLARIFY ATTENDANCE

"Who will attend the administrator training?"

Target

Describes the desired date without silently guaranteeing it.

Depends on

Names the preceding condition rather than blaming another team.

Has accepted

Checks actual ownership, not merely a name on a chart.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID ASSUMING COMPLETION

"A calendar invitation does not mean the training has happened."

STATE A CONDITIONAL SEQUENCE

"Once the approved export is available, we can assess the import schedule."

CHECK SUPPORT

"What support coverage is agreed for the initial operating period?"

AGREE A DECISION RULE

"Confirm launch only after the agreed conditions are met."

SET A REVIEW

"Let us review readiness on Thursday at fifteen hundred UTC."

PROTECT THE DATA

"Use the agreed secure transfer route and only the required fields."

KEEP GAPS VISIBLE

"The export owner and training slot are still open."

CLOSE WITH OWNERSHIP

"I will update the plan with each owner, dependency, and confirmed date."

Once

Makes the sequence conditional on a completed prerequisite.

Still open

Identifies unresolved work without declaring the entire project a failure.

Only after

Makes the readiness condition explicit.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which launch statement is accurate?

- A** Friday is confirmed because both teams want it.
- B** The readiness meeting replaces the test import.
- C** Administrator attendance is unnecessary once invitations are sent.
- D** Friday remains a target pending the four agreed readiness conditions.

2. Which ownership statement matches the brief?

- A** The supplier owns all customer source-data decisions.
- B** Every end user is automatically the migration owner.
- C** The trainer must approve the export simply because training is required.
- D** Customer preparation and supplier mapping are separate responsibilities.

3. What does a training invitation establish?

- A** User acceptance of the main workflow
- B** Approval of every imported record
- C** A proposed or scheduled event, not completed training
- D** Successful administrator practice

4. What belongs in the Thursday decision?

- A** The actual status of each launch condition and any unresolved dependency
- B** Only the number of meetings already held
- C** A launch confirmation regardless of missing evidence
- D** A new date invented without checking availability

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

Turn a hoped-for launch into a shared readiness plan

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

user acceptance / target date / open dependency / data owner / test import / training slot / handover / readiness review / data preparation / success plan

- 01 **Omar:** Our team is expecting to start using the system next Friday. Can you confirm that date so I can send the announcement?
- 02 **Lena:** Friday is still our ¹ _____, but I cannot confirm readiness yet. The export owner and administrator training slot are open. I would like us to settle those responsibilities before you announce a firm launch.
- 03 **Omar:** I thought the supplier handled the migration. Are you saying my team needs to do the technical work as well?
- 04 **Lena:** Let us separate ² _____ from our import work. Your team approves the source export. We map the agreed fields and run the import checks. You do not need to guess how our system processes them.
- 05 **Omar:** That distinction helps. I can coordinate the export, but I need our data lead to confirm when an approved file will be available.
- 06 **Lena:** Please name that person as the ³ _____ in the plan and check their availability. We also need the agreed secure transfer route; please do not send the full customer database in an ordinary email.
- 07 **Omar:** Once the file is available, could the team start working immediately, or is there another check first?
- 08 **Lena:** We need a successful ⁴ _____ before operational use. Then your users need to verify the main workflow against the agreed criteria. A file arriving is progress, but it does not complete those checks.
- 09 **Omar:** I can arrange for two team leads to check the workflow. I will confirm their availability rather than simply put their names in the plan.
- 10 **Lena:** Good. Their ⁵ _____ needs a clear basis: the agreed task, expected result, and any exceptions. We should know what successful completion means before deciding whether the system is ready.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Omar:** The training invitation is not out yet. Our administrator works across two sites, so I need to check which session they can attend.
- 12 **Lena:** I will coordinate the ⁶ _____ with you. Sending an invitation is not the same as completing administrator training, which is one of our launch conditions.
- 13 **Omar:** I still need to tell the wider team something today. I do not want silence to create a different set of expectations.
- 14 **Lena:** Tell them Friday remains the target, with confirmation following the ⁷ _____ on Thursday at fifteen hundred UTC. That gives them a real decision point without implying that unresolved work is already finished.
- 15 **Omar:** What if the export is late but training is complete? Would we still describe the project as ready?
- 16 **Lena:** No. The export would remain an ⁸ _____. We must assess the effect on testing and acceptance rather than count one completed task as a substitute for another.
- 17 **Omar:** Please also make clear who supports the team after launch. They should not have to guess which contact to use.
- 18 **Lena:** We will confirm the ⁹ _____ and initial support arrangements. Coverage and contacts need to be explicit, with any enhanced support period defined rather than assumed to continue indefinitely.
- 19 **Omar:** I will confirm the data lead and user testers, check their availability, and send a conditional update to the team.
- 20 **Lena:** I will update the ¹⁰ _____ with the owners, dependencies, and actual status. At Thursday's review, we will decide from the evidence against all four conditions, not from the date alone.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. target date | 2. data preparation | 3. data owner | 4. test import | 5. user acceptance | 6. training slot | 7. readiness review | 8. open dependency | 9. handover | 10. success plan

Confirm the conditions for another launch

F Say it

A Monday launch remains a target. Customer lead Farah owns source-data approval. Supplier lead Ben owns import mapping. Training is complete, but the test import has failed. The readiness review is Friday at 10:00 UTC.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

test import / 10:00 UTC / target / Farah

Customer: "Monday is still a ¹ _____."

Supplier: "Source-data approval belongs to ² _____."

Customer: "The incomplete technical condition is the ³ _____."

Supplier: "The readiness review is Friday at ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. target | 2. Farah | 3. test import | 4. 10:00 UTC

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The green score hides a workflow gap

A Read the situation

Explain usage measures with the right population and distinguish access from meaningful adoption.

Account C14 has 120 licensed users. In the last 30 days, 100 distinct users logged in. Of the 80 users whose roles require the approval workflow, only 30 completed it at least once. The dashboard health score is green because its current rule emphasizes logins. Customer lead Mei reports that some staff still use email approvals. Customer success manager Daniel must explain the different denominators and investigate the workflow gap without assuming every inactive license is wasted or that the account will certainly cancel.

PEOPLE / Mei: Customer operations lead | Daniel: Customer success manager

CHALLENGE THE MEASURE WITHOUT DISMISSING THE TEAM

A green dashboard can feel reassuring to one team and disconnected from daily work to another. Acknowledge what the measure genuinely shows, then examine the missing outcome. Ask about role, frequency, access, and obstacles before calling users resistant.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many licensed users logged in during the period?

A 100 of 120

B 30 of 120

C 80 of 100

D 30 of 30

2. Which population is relevant to workflow completion here?

A Only the 30 people who completed it

B The number of email messages sent

C The 80 users whose roles require that workflow

D All visitors to the supplier website

3. Why is the dashboard green?

A Every eligible user completed the workflow.

B The customer confirmed all intended outcomes.

C Renewal has already been signed.

D Its current rule emphasizes logins.

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

adoption

Use of a product or workflow in the intended working context.

IN USE assess adoption

licensed user

A person covered by the relevant access entitlement.

IN USE count licensed users

active user

A user meeting a defined activity condition within a stated period.

IN USE define active users

unique user

A distinct person or identity counted once under the measurement rule.

IN USE count unique users

eligible population

The people for whom a particular measure is relevant.

IN USE define the eligible population

denominator

The base quantity used in a fraction or rate.

IN USE state the denominator

login rate

The share of a defined population that logged in during a period.

IN USE calculate the login rate

workflow completion

Finishing the defined sequence of work.

IN USE measure workflow completion

breadth of adoption

How widely relevant use extends across users, teams, or functions.

IN USE assess adoption breadth

depth of adoption

How extensively intended capabilities are used.

IN USE assess adoption depth

frequency

How often a defined action occurs within a period.

IN USE measure usage frequency

cohort

A defined group followed or compared on a shared basis.

IN USE compare user cohorts

Precision check

Login activity is 100 divided by 120, approximately 83.3%. Relevant workflow completion is 30 divided by 80, or 37.5%. Thirty divided by 120 is 25%, but that answers a different question about all licensed users.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

health score

A configured indicator combining selected account signals.

IN USE interpret the health score

weighting

The relative influence assigned to a component in a calculation.

IN USE review score weighting

leading indicator

A measure used as a possible signal of a later result.

IN USE test leading indicators

lagging indicator

A measure of an outcome that has already occurred.

IN USE distinguish lagging indicators

engagement

Participation or interaction under a stated definition.

IN USE assess stakeholder engagement

sentiment

Expressed attitudes or feelings about the relationship or service.

IN USE record customer sentiment

usage telemetry

Recorded data about product interactions.

IN USE validate usage telemetry

instrumentation

The setup used to capture events and measurements.

IN USE check instrumentation

event definition

The rule specifying what a recorded action represents.

IN USE verify event definitions

usage gap

A difference between intended and observed use.

IN USE investigate the usage gap

adoption barrier

A condition making intended use difficult or impractical.

IN USE identify adoption barriers

vanity metric

A flattering measure with weak relevance to the decision at hand.

IN USE question a vanity metric

Precision check

A user who completed the workflow once has met this period metric, not necessarily established a habit. A green health score is a configured signal. Its accuracy and usefulness depend on definitions, data quality, and relevance to the intended customer outcomes.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE SIGNAL

"The login count shows broad access during this period."

SPECIFY THE PERIOD

"These figures cover the last thirty days."

STATE THE RATE

"Thirty of eighty eligible users completed it, which is thirty-seven point five percent."

CHECK THE EVENT

"What exactly triggers a workflow-completed event?"

NAME THE GAP

"It does not show that the approval workflow is being used."

SPECIFY THE POPULATION

"Eighty users have roles that require this workflow."

DISTINGUISH ANOTHER RATE

"Thirty out of all one hundred twenty licenses would answer a different question."

AVOID DOUBLE COUNTING

"Count distinct users, not every repeated login."

Shows

Restricts the claim to what the measure actually establishes.

Does not show

Separates an access event from a completed customer task.

Of eighty

Makes the relevant denominator audible.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASK ABOUT THE OBSTACLE

"Where do people switch back to email?"

CHECK ROLE FIT

"Some licensed users may not need this workflow."

TEST RELEVANCE

"Does this measure connect to the outcome you bought the product for?"

MEASURE AGAIN

"Use the same population and period definition for the follow-up."

KEEP THE CAUSE OPEN

"Low completion does not tell us the reason by itself."

CHALLENGE THE SCORE CAREFULLY

"Green reflects the current scoring rule, not every aspect of account health."

AGREE A TARGETED INTERVENTION

"Let us address the confirmed obstacle before scheduling generic retraining."

CLOSE WITH EVIDENCE

"Record the gap, the confirmed barrier, and the next measurement date."

By itself

Leaves the cause open pending investigation.

Current rule

Explains a dashboard label without presenting it as an objective verdict.

Same definition

Makes later comparisons more meaningful.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement correctly describes workflow use?

- A** Every license without a completed approval is unused.
- B** Thirty completions prove a stable daily habit.
- C** Thirty of eighty eligible users completed it at least once in thirty days.
- D** Eighty-three percent completed it because they logged in.

2. What is the workflow completion percentage?

- A** 83.3%
- B** 62.5%
- C** 37.5%
- D** 25%

3. What should happen before blaming resistance?

- A** Verify event definitions and ask where the workflow breaks down.
- B** Replace the score with a guaranteed cancellation prediction.
- C** Count every login as a completed approval.
- D** Remove users whose roles do not require approval.

4. Which follow-up comparison is sound?

- A** Compare this month's unique users with next month's raw event count.
- B** Change the denominator silently to make the rate rise.
- C** Treat one extra login as proof of realized business value.
- D** Compare the same defined eligible group and period, noting any population changes.

Answers and explanations: [page 78](#).

The green score hides a workflow gap

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

denominator / Frequency / cohort / weighting / event definition / adoption barrier / health score / login rate / usage gap / eligible population

- 01 **Mei:** Your dashboard says our account is healthy, but my supervisors still chase approvals by email. Those two descriptions do not feel consistent.
- 02 **Daniel:** The green ¹ _____ mainly reflects logins at the moment. It tells us something about access, but it does not establish that the approval workflow is replacing email.
- 03 **Mei:** One hundred people logged in. That sounds encouraging, but I do not know how it relates to the work we actually need.
- 04 **Daniel:** It is one hundred distinct users out of one hundred twenty licenses in thirty days. The ² _____ is about eighty-three point three percent. Repeated visits by the same person do not increase that user count.
- 05 **Mei:** Only eighty people have roles that require approvals. The other forty use different parts of the product.
- 06 **Daniel:** Then eighty is the relevant ³ _____ for this workflow measure. Thirty of those eighty completed it at least once, which is thirty-seven point five percent.
- 07 **Mei:** Someone presented thirty out of one hundred twenty in our internal meeting. Was the arithmetic wrong?
- 08 **Daniel:** The arithmetic gives twenty-five percent, but the ⁴ _____ was different. That figure describes completers as a share of all licenses, not completion among the people expected to use approvals.
- 09 **Mei:** Before we act on thirty, I want to know what the system calls a completed approval. Could starting a request count?
- 10 **Daniel:** We should verify the ⁵ _____. A started request and a completed workflow are different events. We need to confirm that the recorded signal matches the action we are discussing.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Mei:** The supervisors say people return to email when they cannot identify the next approver. I do not yet know whether that is configuration or training.
- 12 **Daniel:** That is a useful ⁶ _____ to investigate. Let us look at the affected roles and steps before prescribing another general training session or assuming people simply dislike change.
- 13 **Mei:** Could the score include this workflow information? It is more relevant to our purchase than how often someone opens the homepage.
- 14 **Daniel:** We can review the ⁷ _____ and the signals with our team. The purpose is a more useful account picture, not a different color chosen to justify a conclusion we already want.
- 15 **Mei:** I also want to distinguish someone who tried it once from a team that relies on it throughout the month.
- 16 **Daniel:** Exactly. ⁸ _____ and task context matter alongside the number of users. We should not turn at least once into a claim of regular, independent use.
- 17 **Mei:** Let us begin with the supervisor group that reported the approver problem, then compare the same group after it is addressed.
- 18 **Daniel:** That gives us a defined ⁹ _____. We will record membership changes and keep the completion definition consistent, so a rise does not merely reflect a different population.
- 19 **Mei:** Please keep the renewal discussion separate for now. I am describing a workflow problem, not announcing that we intend to leave.
- 20 **Daniel:** Agreed. The ¹⁰ _____ deserves action, but it does not prove cancellation. We will validate the measure, investigate the approver obstacle, and agree what improvement we should check next.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. health score | 2. login rate | 3. denominator | 4. eligible population | 5. event definition | 6. adoption barrier | 7. weighting | 8. Frequency | 9. cohort | 10. usage gap

Use the correct adoption denominator

F Say it

In one month, 45 of 60 licensed users log in. Only 40 users need the scheduling workflow; 20 of those complete it. A dashboard based on logins does not establish scheduling adoption.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

50% / 40 / 75% / workflow completion

Customer: "The login rate is ¹ _____."

Manager: "The eligible scheduling population is ² _____."

Customer: "The eligible completion rate is ³ _____."

Manager: "A login is not necessarily a ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. 75% | 2. 40 | 3. 50% | 4. workflow completion

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Offer the verified workaround without inventing a fix date

A Read the situation

Communicate confirmed impact, temporary relief, unresolved questions, and the next update under pressure.

Incident I42 prevents scheduled report exports for eight confirmed customer accounts in the EU region. Support has verified an administrator-only manual download workaround for those accounts. It does not restore automated scheduling. Engineering is investigating; neither a permanent-fix date nor the cause is confirmed. An unsent customer message says the issue will be fixed tomorrow. Customer success manager Asha and support lead Leon must correct it. The next customer update is due at 14:00 UTC, even if the investigation has no new result.

PEOPLE / Asha: Customer success manager | Leon: Support lead

CERTAINTY IS NOT THE ONLY FORM OF REASSURANCE

A customer under pressure needs a usable status, not a confident guess. Acknowledge the disruption and give a specific next contact. Explain unfamiliar technical terms in ordinary language, while keeping the approved workaround and its limits intact.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the confirmed impact?

- A** Every EU account has lost its stored data.
- B** Only administrator logins fail.
- C** Scheduled exports fail for eight confirmed EU-region accounts.
- D** All products are unavailable worldwide.

2. What does the workaround provide?

- A** Proof that the incident is closed
- B** Administrator manual downloads, without restored scheduling
- C** A permanent correction of the underlying cause
- D** Automated exports for every account globally

3. What is confirmed about timing?

- A** No message is needed without a new result.
- B** The next update is at 14:00 UTC.
- C** The permanent fix arrives tomorrow.
- D** The root cause will be known by 14:00 UTC.

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

incident

An event disrupting or degrading a service under the relevant process.

IN USE coordinate an incident

confirmed impact

The effect established by available evidence.

IN USE state confirmed impact

affected account

A customer account known to experience the issue.

IN USE identify affected accounts

scheduled export

Data output arranged to run automatically at specified times.

IN USE restore scheduled exports

workaround

A temporary way to reduce impact without fully correcting the underlying issue.

IN USE provide a verified workaround

permanent fix

A correction intended to resolve the underlying defect or cause.

IN USE validate a permanent fix

reproduction

Recreating reported behavior under specified conditions.

IN USE reproduce the issue

support case

A tracked customer request or problem report.

IN USE link the support case

escalation

Routing an issue to a role with appropriate expertise or authority.

IN USE escalate the case

severity

A classification of impact under an organization's incident rules.

IN USE assess incident severity

priority

The order or urgency assigned to work.

IN USE confirm the response priority

incident owner

The person accountable for coordinating the incident response.

IN USE identify the incident owner

Precision check

Eight confirmed accounts is the known scope, not proof that no others are affected. The manual route provides limited relief to administrators. It does not restore scheduling, establish the root cause, or justify saying the incident has been permanently resolved.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

root cause

The underlying cause established through investigation.

IN USE verify the root cause

mitigation

An action reducing impact or risk.

IN USE apply an approved mitigation

restoration

Return of a service or capability to the defined working state.

IN USE confirm service restoration

status update

A communication of current facts and next actions.

IN USE issue a status update

update cadence

The agreed frequency of status communication.

IN USE maintain the update cadence

ETA

Estimated time of arrival or completion; its event and uncertainty must be stated.

IN USE qualify an ETA

UTC

Coordinated Universal Time, a shared time reference.

IN USE specify the time in UTC

known limitation

A confirmed boundary on capability or effectiveness.

IN USE disclose known limitations

scope of impact

The services, users, or accounts affected.

IN USE verify the scope of impact

customer impact

The effect on a customer's work or operations.

IN USE describe customer impact

post-incident review

A later assessment of events, response, and improvements.

IN USE schedule a post-incident review

resolution criterion

A condition used to determine whether the incident can be closed.

IN USE confirm resolution criteria

Precision check

The next-update time and the estimated completion time refer to different events. Asha can promise an update at 14:00 UTC without promising a fix then. Claims about data loss, security, or wider impact require their own verified evidence.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

ACKNOWLEDGE THE IMPACT

"I understand that the missing reports are interrupting your daily review."

KEEP THE SCOPE QUALIFIED

"We are still checking whether other accounts are affected."

STATE THE LIMITATION

"That route does not restore automated scheduling."

CORRECT THE PROMISE

"We do not have a confirmed permanent-fix date."

STATE THE KNOWN SCOPE

"We have confirmed scheduled-export failures in eight EU-region accounts."

EXPLAIN THE WORKAROUND

"Administrators can use the verified manual download route."

PROTECT THE INSTRUCTIONS

"Use the approved steps for the affected account configuration."

SEPARATE TWO EVENTS

"Fourteen hundred UTC is the next update time, not a fix deadline."

Confirmed

Distinguishes verified scope from assumptions about the wider service.

Still checking

Keeps uncertainty visible without implying no investigation is happening.

Does not restore

Makes the temporary route's limitation explicit.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

MAINTAIN CONTACT

"We will update you then even if the investigation is still open."

COORDINATE THE MESSAGE

"Link the customer case to incident I42 so updates stay consistent."

AVOID UNSAFE REASSURANCE

"I cannot make a data-loss or security claim without verified information."

DEFINE CLOSURE

"Confirm restoration against the incident team's agreed criteria."

AVOID INVENTING A CAUSE

"The cause has not yet been confirmed."

CHECK THE CUSTOMER NEED

"Which scheduled report is blocking your immediate work?"

ESCALATE NEW EVIDENCE

"Send the new account details through the approved support route."

CLOSE WITH A CLEAR STATUS

"A workaround is available; investigation continues; the next update is at fourteen hundred UTC."

Next update

Promises communication rather than technical completion.

Has not yet

Describes current knowledge without claiming the cause is unknowable.

Approved steps

Avoids improvising technical instructions in a customer conversation.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

03

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which corrected message is accurate?

- A** Eight reports mean only eight people are affected.
- B** A verified administrator workaround is available; the fix date remains unconfirmed.
- C** All exports will be permanently repaired tomorrow.
- D** A manual download proves automatic scheduling is restored.

2. What should happen at 14:00 UTC if nothing has changed?

- A** Replace the unknown date with tomorrow.
- B** Send the promised update and state that the investigation continues.
- C** Wait silently until engineering has a final answer.
- D** Announce closure because the update deadline has arrived.

3. Which scope statement avoids overclaiming?

- A** The entire service has permanently failed.
- B** Eight accounts are confirmed affected; wider impact is still being checked.
- C** Exactly eight accounts worldwide can possibly be affected.
- D** Every EU account is confirmed affected.

4. Which statement requires additional verified evidence?

- A** No data was lost and no security issue occurred.
- B** The next update is at 14:00 UTC.
- C** Manual download does not restore scheduling.
- D** The permanent-fix date is unconfirmed.

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

Offer the verified workaround without inventing a fix date

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

confirmed impact / workaround / permanent fix / resolution criteria / ETA / update cadence / support case / customer impact / scope of impact / status update

- 01 **Asha:** The customer update says the exports will be fixed tomorrow. Before I send it, has engineering confirmed that date?
- 02 **Leon:** No. The ¹ _____ is still under investigation. Please remove tomorrow. We can give the verified workaround and the next update time, but we should not manufacture a completion estimate.
- 03 **Asha:** The customer is missing its morning reports and wants something useful now. What exactly can we offer?
- 04 **Leon:** The approved ² _____ lets administrators download the reports manually for the affected configuration. It does not restore scheduled delivery, so we need to explain the manual effort and access requirement.
- 05 **Asha:** I will avoid saying exports are fully restored. Do we know how many accounts are affected?
- 06 **Leon:** The ³ _____ is scheduled-export failure in eight accounts in the EU region. That is what we have verified so far, not proof that no additional accounts will report the issue.
- 07 **Asha:** One contact has asked whether the underlying report data has disappeared. I do not see an approved statement about that.
- 08 **Leon:** Do not add one without verification. The ⁴ _____ needs evidence for each claim. We should route the question to the incident team instead of inferring data loss, or its absence, from an export symptom.
- 09 **Asha:** I also need to connect our account's ticket with the wider response. They are currently receiving two different messages.
- 10 **Leon:** Link the ⁵ _____ to I42 and use the approved incident status. Preserve their specific business impact, but do not create a separate fix date in the account notes.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Asha:** Their finance lead needs a report before an afternoon meeting. Can I ask which report is most urgent without changing the incident severity myself?
- 12 **Leon:** Yes. Record the ⁶ _____ and send it through the response process. The team can assess urgency using the actual facts; a forceful message alone does not define the technical severity.
- 13 **Asha:** We promised another message at fourteen hundred UTC. If engineering has no new finding, should I wait until there is more to say?
- 14 **Leon:** Keep the ⁷ _____. At fourteen hundred UTC, state that investigation continues, confirm any unchanged workaround, and give the next communication point agreed by the response team.
- 15 **Asha:** I want to be clear that fourteen hundred refers to communication. Otherwise the customer may hear it as another completion time.
- 16 **Leon:** Exactly. It is not an ⁸ _____ for a fix. Use the words next update and name UTC, rather than saying we will have it for you by two.
- 17 **Asha:** If someone can download the report manually, should support close the incident or leave it open?
- 18 **Leon:** Follow the agreed ⁹ _____. Temporary relief does not by itself show that scheduling is restored. The incident team needs the defined verification before declaring the affected capability resolved.
- 19 **Asha:** Then my message will acknowledge the disruption, give the approved manual option, explain its limit, and keep the fix date unconfirmed.
- 20 **Leon:** Good. Check that the ¹⁰ _____ matches those facts and says when we will contact them again. That is a useful commitment we can keep while the technical investigation continues.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. permanent fix | 2. workaround | 3. confirmed impact | 4. scope of impact | 5. support case | 6. customer impact | 7. update cadence | 8. ETA | 9. resolution criteria | 10. status update

Correct another premature fix promise

F Say it

03

Incident J18 affects automated invoice downloads for five confirmed accounts. An approved manual route is available to administrators. The fix date is unknown. The next update is 11:30 UTC.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

administrator access / unknown / 11:30 UTC / five

Manager: "The known affected-account count is ¹ _____."

Customer: "The temporary route requires ² _____."

Manager: "The permanent-fix date remains ³ _____."

Customer: "The next update is at ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. five | 2. administrator access | 3. unknown | 4. 11:30 UTC

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Replace the impressive ROI claim with a defensible value story

A Read the situation

Present measured change, disclose valuation assumptions, and separate released capacity from proven financial return.

For a quarterly business review, Kira prepares a slide claiming proven savings and return on investment. Customer finance lead Joel confirms logs showing 40 staff hours for one reporting cycle before implementation and 28 for one cycle afterward. Other process changes occurred too. Kira values the 12-hour difference at an unvalidated \$40 per hour and annualizes it over 12 months. The annual subscription costs \$3,600; implementation and training costs are not fully recorded. Staffing expenditure has not changed. The slide must distinguish observations, assumptions, attribution, and missing costs.

PEOPLE / Kira: Customer success manager | Joel: Customer finance lead

A CHALLENGE TO THE NUMBERS CAN STRENGTHEN THE RELATIONSHIP

A customer questioning a value slide is not necessarily rejecting the product. Welcome the distinction between useful operational improvement and an unsupported financial claim. Agree which figures the customer validates, which remain assumptions, and what evidence the next review needs.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What change do the time logs show?

A A \$5,760 reduction in cash expenditure

C A 12-hour difference between the two recorded cycles

B Proof that the product alone caused all improvement

D A verified 12-hour monthly saving for every future month

2. Which input has not been validated?

A The \$40 hourly valuation

C The logged 28-hour later cycle

B The logged 40-hour earlier cycle

D The \$3,600 annual subscription price

3. Why is a proven full ROI claim unsupported?

A Time differences can never be useful.

C The customer has confirmed that all benefits are cash savings.

B Subscription cost is always the only relevant cost.

D Attribution and recurring benefits are unverified, and relevant costs are incomplete.

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

QBR

Quarterly business review; a periodic discussion of outcomes, priorities, and progress.

IN USE prepare a QBR

business outcome

A result relevant to the customer's goals or operations.

IN USE validate business outcomes

baseline

The defined starting measure for a comparison.

IN USE establish a baseline

comparison period

The time window used as the counterpart in an analysis.

IN USE align comparison periods

observed change

A measured difference, without automatically establishing its cause.

IN USE report observed change

attribution

Assigning an effect to a cause or contributor.

IN USE qualify attribution

time saving

A reduction in time required under a stated comparison.

IN USE validate time savings

released capacity

Staff time made available for other work.

IN USE describe released capacity

cash saving

A reduction in actual expenditure under a defined comparison.

IN USE verify cash savings

hourly valuation

The monetary value assigned to an hour for an analysis.

IN USE validate the hourly valuation

annualization

Extending a shorter-period amount to an annual estimate using assumptions.

IN USE disclose annualization assumptions

benefit estimate

A calculated or proposed value not necessarily realized.

IN USE qualify the benefit estimate

Precision check

The observed difference is 40 minus 28, or 12 hours. At the assumed \$40 per hour, that equals \$480 for a cycle. Multiplying by 12 gives \$5,760 only if the monthly frequency, repeated difference, and valuation assumptions hold.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

ROI

Return on investment; net benefit relative to investment cost on a stated basis.

IN USE substantiate ROI

net benefit

Benefits minus included costs under a defined calculation.

IN USE calculate net benefit

cost base

The costs included in a comparison or calculation.

IN USE define the cost base

implementation cost

Expenditure or resources used to introduce the solution.

IN USE capture implementation costs

training cost

The resources or expenditure associated with preparing users.

IN USE include training costs

subscription cost

The recurring access charge under the relevant agreement.

IN USE confirm subscription costs

validation

Checking a claim or measure against appropriate evidence.

IN USE obtain customer validation

value realization

Actual achievement of an intended customer benefit.

IN USE track value realization

confounding factor

Another influence that complicates attribution of an observed change.

IN USE identify confounding factors

sensitivity analysis

Examining how results change when assumptions vary.

IN USE test assumption sensitivity

outcome owner

The person responsible for confirming and tracking the relevant result.

IN USE name the outcome owner

value narrative

An explanation connecting evidence to a customer-relevant benefit.

IN USE build a credible value narrative

Precision check

A common ROI expression is (benefits minus costs) divided by costs, using a defined period and consistent basis. Here neither a complete cost base nor validated recurring monetary benefit is available. Released time is not automatically reduced payroll or cash expenditure.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CORRECTION

"You are right to distinguish the time logs from a proven financial return."

CALCULATE THE DIFFERENCE

"That is twelve fewer hours in the compared cycles."

IDENTIFY ANOTHER INFLUENCE

"Other process changes occurred during the same period."

STATE THE CONDITIONAL FIGURE

"At that rate, twelve hours would be valued at four hundred eighty dollars."

STATE THE OBSERVATION

"The recorded cycle fell from forty staff hours to twenty-eight."

LIMIT THE INFERENCE

"The comparison does not isolate the product's contribution."

LABEL THE VALUATION

"Forty dollars per hour is an assumption that needs your validation."

QUALIFY ANNUALIZATION

"The annual estimate assumes the same benefit in twelve monthly cycles."

Recorded

Grounds the claim in the actual time logs.

Compared cycles

Avoids presenting a limited observation as a permanent monthly result.

At that rate

Makes the monetary figure conditional on the valuation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

DISTINGUISH CAPACITY

"The time difference may release capacity without reducing cash expenditure."

WITHDRAW THE OVERCLAIM

"We should not call this proven ROI."

ASK FOR OWNERSHIP

"Who can validate the time measure and the monetary basis?"

SEPARATE EVIDENCE AND ASSUMPTION

"Let us label each input before discussing the result."

EXPOSE MISSING COSTS

"Implementation and training costs are not fully recorded."

KEEP THE USEFUL RESULT

"The operational change is still worth reporting accurately."

AGREE THE NEXT EVIDENCE

"Compare further cycles using a consistent task definition."

CLOSE THE REVIEW

"We will report the observed change and a plan to validate value over time."

Assumes

Identifies an input that has not been demonstrated.

May release

Keeps potential capacity distinct from verified cash savings.

Still worth reporting

Corrects an overclaim without dismissing a useful operational signal.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. What follows from the stated hourly assumption?

- A** The product alone caused every hour of improvement.
- B** The annual subscription is \$480.
- C** Twelve hours at \$40 would be valued at \$480 per cycle.
- D** The customer has already saved \$480 in cash.

2. What is required to describe \$5,760 responsibly?

- A** State the assumptions of twelve similar monthly cycles and the unvalidated hourly value.
- B** Label it audited annual cash savings.
- C** Treat it as a guaranteed renewal credit.
- D** Omit the period because the number is positive.

3. Which cost statement is accurate?

- A** Subscription cost can be ignored when calculating ROI.
- B** Missing costs prove the investment lost money.
- C** The \$3,600 subscription is known, but the full cost base is incomplete.
- D** All implementation and training costs are confirmed zero.

4. Which review conclusion is strongest?

- A** Keep the proven-ROI headline and hide its assumptions.
- B** Replace missing evidence with a larger hourly rate.
- C** Report the observed operational change and agree a consistent validation plan.
- D** Remove every positive finding because attribution is uncertain.

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

Replace the impressive ROI claim with a defensible value story

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

outcome owner / annualization / hourly valuation / cost base / observed change / released capacity / value narrative / attribution / baseline / value realization

- 01 **Joel:** The slide says proven ROI. I recognize the time logs, but I have not approved the financial claim underneath them.
- 02 **Kira:** You are right. The ¹ _____ is from forty staff hours to twenty-eight for the two recorded cycles. I have moved too quickly from that difference to a broader claim about return.
- 03 **Joel:** There were other process changes at the same time. We simplified the approval route as well as introducing the product.
- 04 **Kira:** Then ² _____ needs qualification. The comparison does not isolate what the product caused. We can report the change without claiming that every hour came from one feature or supplier.
- 05 **Joel:** The twelve-hour difference is correct. Where did the forty-dollar hourly number come from?
- 06 **Kira:** It is an unvalidated ³ _____ in my calculation. At that rate, twelve hours would be worth four hundred eighty dollars for a cycle, but I should not present your approval as already given.
- 07 **Joel:** And the five-thousand-seven-hundred-sixty-dollar annual figure assumes that the same thing happens every month?
- 08 **Kira:** Yes. That ⁴ _____ assumes twelve monthly cycles with the same difference and the same valuation. We have one before-and-after comparison, not twelve months of validated recurring benefits.
- 09 **Joel:** Nobody's pay has changed, and we have not reduced the team. The time may be useful, but it has not disappeared from our expenditure.
- 10 **Kira:** Then ⁵ _____ is the relevant distinction. Staff may use the time for other work. Calling it a cash saving would imply a spending reduction that you have not reported.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Joel:** We pay thirty-six hundred annually for the subscription. The implementation effort and training time are not fully in the model yet.
- 12 **Kira:** The ⁶ _____ is incomplete. A return calculation needs the relevant benefits and costs on a consistent basis and over a defined period, not only the easiest numbers to find.
- 13 **Joel:** I do not want this to sound as though the product has delivered nothing. Our reporting work is clearly taking less recorded time.
- 14 **Kira:** Agreed. We can build a stronger ⁷ _____ around what we know. The recorded change is useful; the mistake was presenting an assumed financial interpretation as an established result.
- 15 **Joel:** For the next review, let us measure the same reporting task across more cycles. Otherwise changes in the task itself could distort the comparison.
- 16 **Kira:** We will keep the ⁸ _____ and task definition explicit. We should also record relevant process changes and exceptions rather than quietly treating unlike cycles as equivalent.
- 17 **Joel:** I can validate the finance inputs, while our operations lead confirms the time records and what people actually do with the released hours.
- 18 **Kira:** Naming an ⁹ _____ for each measure will help. Your finance validation and the operations evidence answer different questions, so neither should be substituted for the other.
- 19 **Joel:** Please revise the slide before the business review. Keep the time difference, but remove the proven-return headline.
- 20 **Kira:** I will describe ¹⁰ _____ only where we have evidence. The revised slide will show the observed twelve-hour difference, label the assumptions, identify missing costs, and state the next validation steps.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. observed change | 2. attribution | 3. hourly valuation | 4. annualization | 5. released capacity | 6. cost base | 7. value narrative | 8. baseline | 9. outcome owner | 10. value realization

Explain another conditional value estimate

F Say it

A team records 30 hours before and 24 hours after a change for one cycle. An unvalidated rate of \$35 per hour is used. Staffing expenditure is unchanged, and implementation costs are missing.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

cash savings / \$210 / implementation costs / six hours

Customer: "The observed time difference is ¹ _____."

Manager: "At the assumed rate, the cycle value would be ² _____."

Customer: "Unchanged expenditure means this is not verified ³ _____."

Manager: "A full return calculation still lacks ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. six hours | 2. \$210 | 3. cash savings | 4. implementation costs

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Rebuild the renewal conversation after the main contact leaves

A Read the situation

Explore changed priorities, verify decision roles, and describe renewal risk without treating it as a verdict.

Account R31 has a \$60,000 annual recurring subscription scheduled for renewal on 12 November, six weeks away. Its main contact has left. New operations contact Ella has not confirmed current priorities or who owns the renewal decision and budget. Earlier reports focused on reducing a service backlog, but the business is now reorganizing. Customer success manager Rafael has no cancellation notice and no renewal approval. Ella agrees to a discovery meeting on 8 October at 10:00 UTC. Actual notice terms and the purchasing route still need checking.

PEOPLE / Ella: New customer operations contact | Rafael: Customer success manager

DO NOT MAKE A NEW CONTACT INHERIT OLD ENTHUSIASM

A replacement stakeholder may have different priorities or knowledge from the previous contact. Give a brief factual handover and invite correction. A change in sponsorship is a reason to learn more, not permission to pressure the new person into endorsing an earlier plan.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the renewal date?

A 8 October

B The day the former contact left

C A new date already approved by Ella

D 12 November

2. What is known about the decision?

A Ella has approved the renewal.

B The former contact's departure cancels the agreement.

C Reorganization guarantees an expansion.

D Neither cancellation nor renewal approval has been received.

3. What is the next agreed customer event?

A A discovery meeting on 8 October at 10:00 UTC

B Contract signature at 10:00 UTC

C Automatic approval of a discount

D Completion of every procurement step

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

renewal

Continuation of an agreement or subscription under applicable terms.

IN USE coordinate a renewal

renewal date

The date specified for the relevant renewal event.

IN USE verify the renewal date

renewal owner

The role coordinating or responsible for the renewal decision process.

IN USE identify the renewal owner

budget owner

The person accountable for the relevant funding decision.

IN USE confirm the budget owner

stakeholder change

A change in people involved in or influencing the relationship.

IN USE track stakeholder changes

executive sponsor

A senior person supporting the initiative within the customer organization.

IN USE reestablish executive sponsorship

champion

An internal advocate who actively helps the initiative progress.

IN USE verify the champion relationship

reorganization

A change in organizational structure, roles, or responsibilities.

IN USE understand reorganization effects

churn risk

The possibility of losing customer business, with its basis specified.

IN USE assess churn risk

logo churn

Loss of customer accounts, distinct from the amount of revenue lost.

IN USE measure logo churn

revenue churn

Recurring revenue lost under a specified measurement definition.

IN USE distinguish revenue churn

contraction

A reduction in business from an existing customer.

IN USE identify contraction risk

Precision check

A contact leaving is a risk signal, not a cancellation. An agreed meeting is progress, not renewal approval. The \$60,000 recurring amount does not include an invented expansion or establish recognized revenue. Verify dates and notice terms in the actual agreement.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

retention

Continuation of customer business under a stated measure.

IN USE improve customer retention

GRR

Gross revenue retention; retained starting recurring revenue excluding expansion on a defined basis.

IN USE calculate GRR

NRR

Net revenue retention; retained starting recurring revenue including expansion on a defined basis.

IN USE calculate NRR

ARR

Annual recurring revenue, measured under the organization's stated inclusion rules.

IN USE verify ARR

risk signal

Evidence that may indicate a potential problem, not a certain outcome.

IN USE record a risk signal

save plan

A defined set of actions addressing an evidenced retention risk.

IN USE agree a save plan

Precision check

For a defined starting cohort, GRR excludes expansion while NRR includes it. If starting recurring revenue is 100, losses are 10, contraction is 5, and expansion is 20, GRR is 85% and NRR is 105%, using the same basis.

renewal forecast

An estimate of renewal outcomes based on current evidence.

IN USE update the renewal forecast

notice provision

A contract term concerning required notices and their conditions.

IN USE review notice provisions

procurement route

The customer's process for reviewing and completing a purchase.

IN USE verify the procurement route

value evidence

Information supporting an actual customer benefit.

IN USE refresh value evidence

success criterion

A condition used to judge achievement of a desired result.

IN USE reconfirm success criteria

renewal plan

A shared sequence of renewal actions, owners, and dates.

IN USE maintain the renewal plan

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE TRANSITION

"I understand that responsibilities have changed since our last review."

GIVE A FACTUAL HANDOVER

"Earlier discussions focused on reducing the service backlog."

CONFIRM THE DATE

"The recorded renewal date is the twelfth of November."

ASK ABOUT OWNERSHIP

"Who now coordinates the renewal decision?"

AVOID INHERITED ASSUMPTIONS

"I do not want to assume the previous priorities are still yours."

ASK ABOUT THE PRESENT

"Which outcomes matter most during the reorganization?"

SEPARATE STATUS FROM RISK

"We have neither a cancellation notice nor renewal approval."

CHECK FUNDING SEPARATELY

"Who owns the relevant budget?"

Still yours

Invites the new stakeholder to confirm or change earlier priorities.

Recorded

Identifies the current document information without inventing revised terms.

Neither ... nor

Keeps both unsupported conclusions out of the status report.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

RESPECT THE NEW CONTACT

"How would you prefer us to involve the other decision participants?"

CHECK CONTRACTUAL DETAILS

"Let us verify the actual notice provisions rather than assume them."

AVOID PREMATURE DISCOUNTING

"We should understand the issue before proposing a commercial change."

KEEP THE FORECAST HONEST

"The outcome remains unconfirmed while those gaps are open."

VERIFY THE PROCESS

"We need the current purchasing route and required steps."

USE EVIDENCE

"Which results can your team validate from the last period?"

MAKE THE NEXT MEETING USEFUL

"Let us use the eighth of October to confirm priorities and decision roles."

CLOSE THE PLAN

"Record each action, owner, evidence source, and next date."

Now

Recognizes that decision roles may have changed.

Before proposing

Sequences diagnosis ahead of a commercial response.

Unconfirmed

Avoids disguising uncertainty as either retention or loss.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which internal renewal update is justified?

- A** The contact has changed; priorities and decision roles need confirmation; the outcome is open.
- B** The account is lost because the old contact left.
- C** The renewal is certain because a meeting is booked.
- D** An immediate discount has already solved the risk.

2. What should Rafael ask Ella first?

- A** What matters now and who participates in the decision
- B** Why she has already rejected the product
- C** Whether she will approve an unspecified discount today
- D** Why she must preserve the former contact's priorities

3. For starting recurring revenue 100, loss 10, contraction 5, and expansion 20, what is GRR?

- A** 115%
- B** 85%
- C** 105%
- D** 95%

4. Using those same figures, what is NRR?

- A** 105%
- B** 85%
- C** 80%
- D** 120%

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

Rebuild the renewal conversation after the main contact leaves

E Conversations / turns 1-10

05

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

procurement route / renewal forecast / risk signal / save plan / success criteria / budget owner / stakeholder change / renewal plan / renewal owner / value evidence

- 01 **Rafael:** Thank you for taking over the conversation. The account is due for renewal on the twelfth of November, and I would like to understand what has changed.
- 02 **Ella:** I can discuss operations, but I have only recently inherited this relationship. I do not yet know who is the ¹ _____ across our reorganized teams.
- 03 **Rafael:** That is helpful to know. Our earlier reviews focused on reducing the service backlog, but I do not want to assume that is still the main priority.
- 04 **Ella:** Backlog matters, but we are also combining two service teams. The ² _____ may need to change. I need to speak with the new director before confirming what the combined team requires.
- 05 **Rafael:** We can use our meeting on the eighth of October at ten hundred UTC to clarify that. Who else should contribute to the discussion?
- 06 **Ella:** Let me check the roles first. I do not want an invitation to imply that I am the ³ _____ or that finance has already approved continuation.
- 07 **Rafael:** Agreed. We can distinguish operational needs, funding, and purchasing steps. I will keep you involved as we establish the right route.
- 08 **Ella:** Please do. The ⁴ _____ has left some history scattered across people. A brief factual handover would help more than a presentation assuming everyone already supports the old plan.
- 09 **Rafael:** I can summarize the agreed objectives, recorded usage, and the results previously discussed, marking anything that still needs your validation.
- 10 **Ella:** That ⁵ _____ will be useful. Please separate actual outcomes from estimates. The new director will ask what the team gained, not simply how many meetings the supplier held.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Rafael:** Understood. Internally, I have recorded the contact change as something we need to address, not as proof that the account is leaving.
- 12 **Ella:** Good. A ⁶ _____ is not a decision from us. We have sent neither a cancellation notice nor an approval to renew.
- 13 **Rafael:** Before we discuss terms, we should also verify the agreement's notice requirements and the current purchasing steps. I do not want to assume how those work.
- 14 **Ella:** I can help locate the right colleagues. The ⁷ _____ may have changed in the reorganization, so last year's contacts are not necessarily the people who can complete this year's process.
- 15 **Rafael:** Someone suggested offering a discount immediately. I would rather first understand whether the issue is fit, budget, process, or simply missing information.
- 16 **Ella:** That makes sense. A ⁸ _____ built around the wrong problem will not help us decide. There is no confirmed price objection for you to solve today.
- 17 **Rafael:** I will keep the forecast open while we establish those facts. A scheduled discussion should not be reported as a completed renewal.
- 18 **Ella:** Please make the ⁹ _____ reflect that distinction. We can make progress without pretending the commercial decision has already happened.
- 19 **Rafael:** For the eighth, I will bring the factual history and open questions. You will confirm which roles should attend and what priorities they can speak to.
- 20 **Ella:** Yes. Then we can build a ¹⁰ _____ with the actual decision participants, owners, and dates. Keep the twelfth of November visible, but do not use it to invent approvals we have not given.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. renewal owner | 2. success criteria | 3. budget owner | 4. stakeholder change | 5. value evidence | 6. risk signal | 7. procurement route | 8. save plan | 9. renewal forecast | 10. renewal plan

Describe another renewal without guessing the outcome

F Say it

Account T08 renews on 20 December. Its sponsor has moved roles. New contact Hugo agrees to a needs review on 4 November but has not confirmed the budget owner. No renewal or cancellation decision is recorded.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

20 December / needs review / open / unconfirmed

Manager: "The recorded renewal date is ¹ _____."

Contact: "The fourth of November is a ² _____."

Manager: "The funding decision role remains ³ _____."

Contact: "The commercial outcome is still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. 20 December | 2. needs review | 3. unconfirmed | 4. open

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Check the existing capacity before selling more seats

A Read the situation

Explore additional demand, verify license rights, and align expansion with readiness and customer benefit.

06

Customer administrator Nora asks success manager Sam for 25 additional licenses for a new team. The account already holds 80 named-user licenses: 50 assigned and 30 unassigned. Of the 50 assigned users, 35 have completed onboarding. The new team needs the same proposed workflow, but its requirements and training availability are unconfirmed. Use of existing unassigned seats requires the customer license owner to confirm entitlement and allocation. No additional purchase or allocation has been approved. Sam must assess fit and readiness before presenting a justified commercial option.

PEOPLE / Nora: Customer administrator | Sam: Customer success manager

A USEFUL COMMERCIAL CONVERSATION CAN BEGIN WITH RESTRAINT

Customers may ask for a product quantity as a shortcut to describing a business need. Clarify the need and existing capacity before assuming the right purchase. Explain remaining work honestly, and do not use an adoption problem merely as a reason to withhold a suitable option.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many existing seats are unassigned?

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| A 50 | B 30 |
| C 25 | D 15 |

2. How many assigned users have completed onboarding?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------|
| A 35 of 80 newly added users | B 50 of 50 |
| C 25 of 30 | D 35 of 50 |

3. What must happen before using existing unassigned seats?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Training completion automatically changes the contract. | B The customer license owner must confirm entitlement and allocation. |
| C Sam may silently assign them to any organization. | D A new order must always be signed first. |

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

expansion

Growth in business with an existing customer.

IN USE assess an expansion opportunity

upsell

A move to a higher-value quantity, tier, or offering.

IN USE justify an upsell

cross-sell

Sale of a different, related offering to an existing customer.

IN USE assess cross-sell fit

seat

A unit of user access under specified licensing terms.

IN USE count available seats

named-user license

An access entitlement assigned to an identified individual under the agreement.

IN USE verify named-user licenses

concurrent-user license

Access measured by simultaneous use under the agreement's rules.

IN USE distinguish concurrent-user licensing

assigned seat

A license allocated to a specified user under the relevant rules.

IN USE review assigned seats

unassigned seat

A license not currently allocated to a user.

IN USE verify unassigned seats

license utilization

Use or allocation of licenses under a stated measurement definition.

IN USE define license utilization

entitlement

The access or usage rights granted by the applicable agreement.

IN USE confirm entitlement

allocation

Assignment of available resources or access to a purpose or user.

IN USE approve license allocation

license owner

The customer role responsible for managing the relevant license rights.

IN USE consult the license owner

Precision check

The account has 30 unassigned seats, but availability is not automatically permission to allocate them. If the license owner authorizes 25 of those seats for the new team, 5 would remain unassigned; no additional quantity is assumed necessary from the count alone.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

onboarding completion

Completion of defined preparation steps for a user or group.

IN USE verify onboarding completion

readiness gap

A missing condition needed for effective use.

IN USE address readiness gaps

incremental demand

Additional need beyond an established baseline.

IN USE establish incremental demand

fit assessment

Evaluation of whether an offering meets the relevant needs.

IN USE conduct a fit assessment

commercial option

A proposed purchase arrangement with defined scope and terms.

IN USE compare commercial options

order form

The document specifying the relevant purchase details and terms.

IN USE review the order form

proration

Proportional charging for a partial period under stated rules.

IN USE explain proration

co-termination

Aligning the end dates of subscriptions under agreed terms.

IN USE discuss co-termination

true-up

Adjustment to align reported or licensed usage with contractual requirements.

IN USE review true-up terms

shelfware

Informal term for purchased software that is little used or unused.

IN USE investigate shelfware

expansion readiness

Evidence that added scope can be used effectively.

IN USE assess expansion readiness

customer benefit

A relevant advantage for the customer, supported by evidence or clearly labeled assumptions.

IN USE establish customer benefit

Precision check

Onboarding completion is 35 of 50 assigned users, or 70%. That is not 70% of all 80 licenses, and it does not prove independent workflow use. Named-user rights must not be treated as permission to share one identity among several people.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

EXPLORE THE REQUEST

"What work will the twenty-five new users need to complete?"

QUALIFY AVAILABILITY

"We need the license owner to confirm that those seats can be allocated to this team."

CHECK THE ARITHMETIC

"Allocating twenty-five existing seats would leave five unassigned."

STATE THE READINESS GAP

"Fifteen currently assigned users have not completed onboarding."

CHECK CURRENT CAPACITY

"The account has thirty unassigned seats."

AVOID AN AUTOMATIC SALE

"The request does not yet establish a need for twenty-five additional licenses."

RESPECT THE TERMS

"Allocation must follow the actual entitlement and approved process."

AVOID A FALSE EQUIVALENCE

"Training completion does not prove regular workflow use."

Does not yet

Leaves room for evidence that an additional purchase is genuinely needed.

Would leave

Makes the arithmetic conditional on authorized allocation.

Separate confirmation

Prevents licensing rights from being confused with practical readiness.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASK ABOUT RESOURCES

"Who will own onboarding for the new team?"

KEEP ALTERNATIVES OPEN

"A justified additional purchase remains an option if existing rights do not meet the need."

AVOID PRESSURE

"I will not invent an expiry date to accelerate the purchase."

AVOID CREDENTIAL SHARING

"Use the approved user-access arrangement rather than shared named-user identities."

ASSESS FIT

"Let us confirm their workflow and access requirements."

SEPARATE TWO DECISIONS

"License allocation and readiness for use need separate confirmation."

EXPLAIN AN ACTUAL QUOTE

"Any proposal will show quantity, term, charges, and approval status."

CLOSE WITH NEXT STEPS

"Verify entitlement, confirm the workflow, and agree the onboarding owner before recommending quantity."

06

Remains an option

Avoids treating responsible assessment as a blanket refusal to sell.

Actual entitlement

Directs the decision to the governing rights, not a dashboard count alone.

Before recommending

Connects the commercial recommendation to established customer need.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which response best fits the request?

- A** Promise free reassignment before the license owner confirms it.
- B** Refuse every expansion until all users complete every possible feature.
- C** Confirm needs and allocation rights before deciding whether additional licenses are necessary.
- D** Immediately quote 25 new seats without checking existing capacity.

2. If 25 existing unassigned seats are authorized for the new team, how many remain?

- A** 55
- B** 5
- C** 15
- D** 30

3. What is the stated onboarding completion rate among assigned users?

- A** 70%
- B** 43.75%
- C** 62.5%
- D** 30%

4. Which proposal would be transparent?

- A** A quantity chosen only to meet the supplier's target
- B** A promise that every unassigned seat may be used anywhere
- C** A shared-login plan presented as named-user compliance
- D** A justified quantity with term, charges, allocation basis, and approval status

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

Check the existing capacity before selling more seats

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

fit assessment / named-user licenses / entitlement / readiness gap / allocation / onboarding completion / commercial option / Expansion readiness / unassigned seats / incremental demand

- 01 **Nora:** We are adding another team. Could you send an order for twenty-five more licenses so I can get them started?
- 02 **Sam:** I can help assess that, but let us check the existing ¹ _____ first. Your account has eighty licenses, fifty assigned and thirty unassigned. We should understand whether the new team needs additional rights or an allocation of existing capacity.
- 03 **Nora:** They expect to use the same approval workflow. Does having thirty spare seats mean I can assign twenty-five immediately?
- 04 **Sam:** We need the license owner to confirm the ² _____ and allocation. The count shows potential capacity, but I should not interpret the agreement or approve a different team's access on your behalf.
- 05 **Nora:** I will involve our license owner. If those seats can be allocated, the remaining number would be five, correct?
- 06 **Sam:** Correct, subject to that approved ³ _____. Twenty-five taken from thirty leaves five. It would not increase the total from eighty to one hundred five.
- 07 **Nora:** I also see that only thirty-five of our fifty assigned users have finished onboarding. I do not want the new group to repeat the same difficulties.
- 08 **Sam:** That ⁴ _____ figure is seventy percent of assigned users. We should identify the unfinished steps and barriers, but we should not assume every person has the same problem or that training alone proves adoption.
- 09 **Nora:** The new team has not confirmed who will attend training. Their manager asked for access before discussing the practical schedule.
- 10 **Sam:** That is a ⁵ _____ separate from license quantity. Who will own their preparation, and when can the relevant users practice the workflow they actually need?

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Nora:** I can ask the manager. Would you still be willing to quote more seats if our existing rights do not cover that team?
- 12 **Sam:** Certainly. We should establish ⁶ _____ after checking the actual rights and requirements. A suitable additional purchase is a valid option; it just needs a customer basis rather than an assumption from the first request.
- 13 **Nora:** Their process may include an extra approval step. We have not confirmed whether the current configuration supports it.
- 14 **Sam:** Then include that in the ⁷ _____. More seats do not solve a workflow mismatch by themselves. We should check capability and configuration alongside the training plan.
- 15 **Nora:** Some teams have shared access in other systems. I assume that is not something we should improvise here.
- 16 **Sam:** Correct. These are ⁸ _____. Follow the approved identity and access arrangement; do not use shared credentials as a shortcut around the actual license or security requirements.
- 17 **Nora:** Once we know the right quantity, I will need a clear explanation of the term and any partial-period charge.
- 18 **Sam:** Any ⁹ _____ should show those details, including the applicable charging basis. I will not invent a discount deadline or imply a new order is approved before your purchasing process is complete.
- 19 **Nora:** Then the immediate decision is not buy twenty-five or buy nothing. It is establish what rights and preparation the team needs.
- 20 **Sam:** Exactly. ¹⁰ _____ comes from those facts. Let us confirm the license owner, the workflow requirements, and the onboarding owner, then recommend the quantity and arrangement that actually serve the team.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. unassigned seats | 2. entitlement | 3. allocation | 4. onboarding completion | 5. readiness gap | 6. incremental demand | 7. fit assessment | 8. named-user licenses | 9. commercial option | 10. Expansion readiness

Assess another request for more licenses

F Say it

An account has 100 licenses, with 70 assigned and 30 unassigned. A new team needs 20 users. Existing allocation rights need confirmation. Of the 70 assigned users, 49 have completed onboarding.

06

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

70% / entitlement / 30 / ten

Manager: "The unassigned count is ¹ _____."

Customer: "If twenty existing seats are authorized, ² _____ remain."

Manager: "Onboarding completion among assigned users is ³ _____."

Customer: "Before allocation, we must confirm ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. 30 | 2. ten | 3. 70% | 4. entitlement

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Discover the workflow behind the requested button

A Read the situation

Turn a proposed feature into a precise problem, usable evidence, and a responsible product-team handoff.

Customer operations lead Nia requests a bulk-approval button. Twenty approvers handle about 200 requests weekly; around 40 need individual exception review. Staff report repeated navigation between similar requests. The customer requires a separate authorized decision record for each request. The current product offers a saved filtered view but no confirmed bulk-approval capability. Success manager Teo must clarify the repeated work and pass the need to product manager Arun. Logging the request does not assign delivery priority or a release date. Any interim approach must preserve the decision-record requirement.

PEOPLE / Nia: Customer operations lead | Teo: Customer success manager

07

RESPECT THE PROPOSED SOLUTION WHILE EXPLORING THE PROBLEM

A customer may name a feature because it is the clearest way to express frustration. Do not dismiss the idea as merely a request. Ask for the relevant sequence and obstacle, then confirm the problem in words the customer recognizes before discussing alternative approaches.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What problem has the customer reported?

A A confirmed inability to sign in

C A request to remove all authorization

B A verified loss of all approval records

D Repeated navigation between similar approval requests

2. What record must an interim approach preserve?

A A separate authorized decision for each request

C No record for routine requests

B Only one anonymous decision per week

D A single record covering all twenty approvers

3. What does logging the feature request establish?

A That the need has been recorded for assessment

C The highest priority in the product plan

B A committed delivery date

D A capability already released to all customers

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

feature request

A proposal for a product capability or change.

IN USE capture a feature request

problem statement

A clear description of the difficulty to be addressed.

IN USE refine the problem statement

use case

A specific situation in which a capability would be used.

IN USE document the use case

workflow

The sequence of activities used to complete a task.

IN USE map the workflow

friction point

A step that creates avoidable difficulty or effort.

IN USE identify friction points

bulk action

An operation applied to multiple selected items.

IN USE assess bulk-action needs

exception handling

The treatment of cases outside the normal pattern.

IN USE preserve exception handling

audit trail

A traceable record of actions and decisions.

IN USE preserve the audit trail

authorization

Permission to perform a specified action.

IN USE verify authorization

saved view

A reusable display configured with selected criteria.

IN USE configure a saved view

filter

A rule selecting which items are shown or processed.

IN USE validate the filter

interim approach

A temporary way of working pending a longer-term decision.

IN USE assess an interim approach

Precision check

About 200 requests and 40 exceptions suggest about 160 non-exception requests in that weekly pattern, not 160 automatically approvable records. Routine status does not remove the stated requirement for an authorized decision on each request.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

user story

A concise expression of a user's need and intended value.

IN USE refine a user story

acceptance criteria

Conditions used to judge whether a proposed solution meets the need.

IN USE define acceptance criteria

reproduction steps

A sequence allowing others to observe reported behavior.

IN USE provide reproduction steps

representative example

An example reflecting the relevant real-world pattern.

IN USE select representative examples

frequency

How often the relevant situation or action occurs.

IN USE quantify task frequency

impact statement

An explanation of how a problem affects the customer's work.

IN USE verify the impact statement

product backlog

A maintained collection of potential product work.

IN USE review the product backlog

prioritization

Deciding the relative order or importance of work.

IN USE explain prioritization

feasibility

Whether a proposed approach can be achieved under relevant constraints.

IN USE assess feasibility

roadmap

A communicated plan for product direction and anticipated work.

IN USE qualify roadmap information

discovery

Investigation of needs, context, and possible solutions.

IN USE support product discovery

feedback loop

A process that returns assessment or outcome information to the source.

IN USE close the feedback loop

Precision check

A saved filtered view may reduce navigation, but it is not a bulk-approval capability. A logged request, a backlog entry, a roadmap item, and a released feature are different statuses. Confirm the actual status and its limits before communicating availability.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

RESPECT THE IDEA

"I understand why a bulk-approval button sounds useful."

IDENTIFY THE OBSTACLE

"Is the main effort navigation, comparison, or the decision itself?"

SEPARATE EXCEPTIONS

"Which cases still need individual investigation?"

CHECK THE CURRENT OPTION

"The saved view may reduce navigation, but it is not bulk approval."

EXPLORE THE SEQUENCE

"Walk me through the repeated steps between two similar requests."

QUANTIFY FREQUENCY

"About how many requests follow this pattern each week?"

PRESERVE THE REQUIREMENT

"Every request must retain its own authorized decision record."

AVOID PREMATURE ADVICE

"We need to verify the filter and permissions before recommending that approach."

Sounds useful

Respects the proposed solution without claiming it is the chosen design.

Main effort

Distinguishes navigation from the judgment the user still needs to make.

While preserving

States a constraint that a faster approach must continue to satisfy.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

STATE THE PROBLEM

"Repeated navigation slows review of similar requests."

REQUEST MINIMAL EVIDENCE

"An approved, de-identified example of the workflow is enough for the initial assessment."

KEEP STATUS CLEAR

"Recorded for assessment does not mean scheduled for release."

RETURN THE RESPONSE

"I will bring the product team's assessment back to you."

DEFINE A USEFUL RESULT

"Reduce repeated navigation while preserving individual decisions and exception visibility."

EXPLAIN THE HANDOFF

"I will send the problem, frequency, impact, constraints, and examples to Arun."

AVOID A ROADMAP PROMISE

"I do not have an approved delivery date to share."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"Let us confirm that this summary captures your need before we submit it."

07

May reduce

Labels the interim option as something to assess, not a proven outcome.

Recorded for assessment

Names a real status without implying implementation.

Captures your need

Checks that the handoff represents the customer accurately.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which problem statement best represents the case?

- A** Repeated navigation slows similar-request review while individual decisions must remain traceable.
- B** The customer wants every request approved without review.
- C** Forty exceptions prove that the entire product is unusable.
- D** A new button is already approved for release.

2. Which interim statement is responsible?

- A** A saved view automatically approves all visible records.
- B** Routine requests no longer need individual decisions.
- C** Any filter can replace the approval controls.
- D** A saved view may help navigation, subject to verified filters and permissions.

3. What should the product handoff include?

- A** The workflow, frequency, impact, constraints, and representative approved examples
- B** Only the proposed button color
- C** A promised release date invented by the success manager
- D** Unnecessary unredacted customer records sent through any channel

4. Which customer update correctly describes backlog status?

- A** Backlog entry guarantees delivery this month.
- B** Logging the request completes acceptance testing.
- C** A roadmap discussion means the feature is already available.
- D** The request is recorded for assessment; priority and delivery timing are not confirmed.

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

Discover the workflow behind the requested button

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

feedback loop / audit trail / saved view / problem statement / impact statement / feature request / acceptance criteria / product backlog / Prioritization / use case

07

- 01 **Nia:** Could you add a bulk-approval button? Our approvers spend too much time opening similar requests one after another.
- 02 **Teo:** I understand the ¹ _____. Before I pass it to product, can we identify which repeated steps are taking the time: finding the next request, comparing details, or making the decision?
- 03 **Nia:** Navigation is the part people complain about most. Twenty approvers handle about two hundred requests a week, and around forty need closer exception review.
- 04 **Teo:** Then the ² _____ should name that repeated navigation. We should also preserve the distinction between similar requests and exceptions rather than assume all two hundred can be handled identically.
- 05 **Nia:** Yes. Even a routine request needs its own authorized decision. We cannot lose the record of who decided what.
- 06 **Teo:** That ³ _____ is a required constraint, not an optional detail. About one hundred sixty non-exception requests does not mean one hundred sixty records can be approved without an individual decision.
- 07 **Nia:** We currently move back to the full list after each review. Could the product at least keep the relevant requests together?
- 08 **Teo:** There is a ⁴ _____ that may help navigation. We need to check its filters and permissions for your workflow. It is not a bulk-approval function, and I do not want to describe it as one.
- 09 **Nia:** We can test whether the view helps, provided the exceptions stay visible and nobody gains permission they should not have.
- 10 **Teo:** Those are useful ⁵ _____ for assessing an interim approach. We can check navigation, exception visibility, and the required individual decision record without removing the controls to make the demonstration look faster.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Nia:** What does Arun need from us? I do not want my team to produce a long specification before anyone looks at the need.
- 12 **Teo:** A concise ⁶ _____ is enough for the initial discussion: who performs the task, the repeated steps, the frequency, and the obstacle. An approved de-identified example will help; we do not need unnecessary customer records.
- 13 **Nia:** Please include the distinction between navigation and decision effort. I do not want the team to hear that we asked to eliminate review.
- 14 **Teo:** I will include that in the ⁷ _____. I will send the workflow, frequency, constraints, and examples to Arun, then confirm that the summary represents what you actually need.
- 15 **Nia:** Once the request is logged, does that mean it is in the next release? I need to explain the status internally.
- 16 **Teo:** No. A ⁸ _____ entry records potential work. Product still needs to assess the need, alternatives, effort, and wider priorities. I do not have an approved release date to share.
- 17 **Nia:** Could another customer need move ahead of ours even if our request came first?
- 18 **Teo:** Yes. ⁹ _____ considers more than submission order. I can explain the assessment status and the evidence we supplied, but I cannot promise a ranking before that decision is made.
- 19 **Nia:** Then keep us informed when the assessment changes, including if the team proposes a different way to solve the problem.
- 20 **Teo:** I will close the ¹⁰ _____. We will test the bounded interim option, preserve your decision requirements, and return the product response without confusing an idea, a plan, and a released capability.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. feature request | 2. problem statement | 3. audit trail | 4. saved view | 5. acceptance criteria | 6. use case | 7. impact statement | 8. product backlog | 9. Prioritization | 10. feedback loop

Clarify another requested feature

F Say it

A customer requests one-click batch closure for service tickets. The reported problem is repeated navigation. Each ticket must retain an authorized closure record. A saved queue view exists, but batch closure has not been confirmed or scheduled.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

saved queue view / repeated navigation / not scheduled / authorized closure record

Customer: "The reported obstacle is ¹ _____."

Manager: "Each ticket must retain an ² _____."

Customer: "The existing capability is a ³ _____."

Manager: "The release status for batch closure is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. repeated navigation | 2. authorized closure record | 3. saved queue view | 4. not scheduled

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Repair the expectation without promising a date you cannot confirm

A Read the situation

Acknowledge impact, reconcile disputed records, and set a respectful boundary while keeping support available.

Customer lead Beth says an export feature was promised for October and demands confirmation of 31 October. The available 17 September note says the team is targeting late October, subject to testing; it does not record a confirmed release date. Success manager Idris must check any additional evidence rather than deny that other conversations occurred. He can arrange a manager review and provide a status update by 15:00 UTC on Thursday. He cannot approve compensation or promise delivery. Company procedure allows a pause after a clear boundary if personal insults continue, while preserving an appropriate support route.

PEOPLE / Beth: Customer team lead | Idris: Customer success manager

08

FIRM DISSATISFACTION IS NOT AUTOMATICALLY ABUSE

A customer can dispute the record, demand accountability, or speak directly without crossing a conduct boundary. Respond to the substance first. If comments become personal, name the behavior calmly and offer a way to continue the work; do not use a boundary to avoid a legitimate complaint.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the available 17 September note say?

- A Late October is a target subject to testing.
- C 31 October is an unconditional confirmed date.

- B The feature is already released.
- D Compensation has been approved.

2. What can Idris commit to?

- A A status update by Thursday at 15:00 UTC
- C An immediate financial credit

- B Delivery by 31 October
- D A finding that no other promise could have occurred

3. What should happen if other evidence exists?

- A Ignore it because the available note is enough to settle every issue.
- C Treat it as automatic permission for Idris to approve compensation.

- B Alter the original note to match the new account.
- D Preserve and review it through the appropriate process.

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

expectation gap

A difference between what someone expected and what is currently understood or available.

IN USE address the expectation gap

conditional estimate

A forecast dependent on stated assumptions or events.

IN USE explain a conditional estimate

confirmed commitment

An undertaking established through the relevant authorized process.

IN USE verify a confirmed commitment

qualification

Wording that limits or conditions a statement.

IN USE preserve the qualification

delivery status

The current state of work toward making a capability available.

IN USE verify delivery status

disputed record

Information whose meaning, completeness, or accuracy is challenged.

IN USE reconcile a disputed record

contemporaneous note

A note made at or near the time of the relevant event.

IN USE preserve contemporaneous notes

supporting evidence

Information that helps assess a claim or account.

IN USE request supporting evidence

acknowledgment

Recognition of a concern or impact without necessarily accepting every claim.

IN USE give a clear acknowledgment

service recovery

Work to address a service problem and rebuild trust.

IN USE coordinate service recovery

complaint escalation

Routing a complaint to the appropriate reviewer or authority.

IN USE arrange complaint escalation

review owner

The person responsible for coordinating an assessment.

IN USE identify the review owner

Precision check

Targeting late October, subject to testing is conditional wording. It does not establish the requested 31 October commitment in the available note. That distinction does not prove that no other conversation or document exists, or determine any contractual remedy.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

compensation request

A request for money, credit, or another remedy.

IN USE route a compensation request

commercial authority

Permission to make specified business decisions or commitments.

IN USE confirm commercial authority

resolution path

The route for assessing and addressing an issue.

IN USE explain the resolution path

boundary

A stated limit on conduct or participation.

IN USE set a respectful boundary

personal insult

A demeaning remark directed at a person rather than the work or issue.

IN USE address personal insults

de-escalation

Communication aimed at reducing tension while addressing the issue.

IN USE use de-escalation language

pause

A temporary interruption with its purpose and next route clarified.

IN USE explain a call pause

continuity of support

Maintaining an appropriate way to receive assistance.

IN USE preserve continuity of support

factual chronology

A time-ordered account of events and evidence.

IN USE compile a factual chronology

read-back

Repeating key points so another person can confirm or correct them.

IN USE give a closing read-back

follow-through

Completing and communicating agreed actions.

IN USE demonstrate follow-through

trust repair

Rebuilding confidence through accurate communication and reliable action.

IN USE support trust repair

08

Precision check

Acknowledging disruption does not require agreeing to an unverified date or compensation. A conduct boundary addresses behavior, not the legitimacy of the complaint. If a pause is needed under the stated procedure, explain the continuing support route and next contact.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE EFFECT

"I understand that your team planned around an October expectation."

STATE THE AVAILABLE WORDING

"The note says late October, subject to testing."

AVOID A BLANKET DENIAL

"I am not saying that no other conversation occurred."

TAKE OWNERSHIP OF REVIEW

"I will arrange the manager review and preserve the records you provide."

INVITE THE EVIDENCE

"Please share the message or meeting record you relied on."

KEEP THE RECORD QUALIFIED

"I have not yet reviewed every relevant communication."

SEPARATE THE DATE

"I cannot confirm the thirty-first of October from the information available."

SET THE NEXT UPDATE

"I will update you by Thursday at fifteen hundred UTC."

08

Planned around

Acknowledges reliance and impact without deciding an unreviewed legal claim.

Available

Limits the statement to the information currently checked.

Not saying

Corrects an overly broad interpretation without retreating from the verified wording.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID PROMISING THE RESULT

"That update may report that the review is still pending."

ACCEPT DIRECT CRITICISM

"You can challenge our handling of the issue."

EXPLAIN A POSSIBLE PAUSE

"If the personal insults continue, we will pause this call and use the agreed support route."

CONFIRM THE READ-BACK

"Your concern is the missed expectation, the operational impact, and the requested review."

ROUTE THE REMEDY REQUEST

"I can record your compensation request, but I cannot approve it."

NAME THE CONDUCT BOUNDARY

"I want to continue helping; please keep comments focused on the issue rather than personal insults."

KEEP SUPPORT AVAILABLE

"The complaint will remain open through that route."

CLOSE WITH FOLLOW-THROUGH

"I will send the factual summary, the review owner, and the promised update time."

May report pending

Prevents the update time from becoming an implied resolution deadline.

Focused on the issue

Defines a behavior boundary while leaving criticism and complaint available.

Remain open

Preserves the route for legitimate review after a pause.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response addresses the disputed promise accurately?

- A** The available note is conditional; let us review any other records you relied on.
- B** No other promise could possibly have been made.
- C** An estimate automatically becomes a confirmed release date.
- D** The customer's frustration proves delivery was guaranteed.

2. Which statement preserves a useful communication commitment?

- A** I will respond only after the customer stops disagreeing.
- B** The meeting time itself confirms a favorable decision.
- C** I will update you by Thursday at 15:00 UTC, even if review is still pending.
- D** I guarantee the requested feature and compensation by that time.

3. Which behavior alone does not justify treating the customer as abusive?

- A** Repeated personal insults after a clear boundary
- B** Demeaning comments directed at the employee
- C** Continuing personal attacks instead of discussing the issue
- D** Firmly disputing the record and requesting accountability

4. If the stated procedure requires a pause, what should Idris preserve?

- A** A clear support route, complaint record, owner, and next contact
- B** A threat to erase the complaint
- C** An unapproved credit in exchange for silence
- D** A claim that the original concern is now invalid

Answers and explanations: [page 90](#).

Repair the expectation without promising a date you cannot confirm

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

review owner / boundary / supporting evidence / Trust repair / resolution path / conditional estimate / expectation gap / compensation request / complaint escalation / read-back

08

- 01 **Beth:** We planned around an October release. Now I am hearing uncertainty. I need you to confirm the thirty-first so our team knows where it stands.
- 02 **Idris:** I understand the ¹ _____ and the disruption. I cannot confirm that date, but I want to review exactly what your team was told.
- 03 **Beth:** The discussion was much more definite than that. I do not want you to use one note to dismiss everything we heard.
- 04 **Idris:** I will not. The available note records a ² _____ for late October, subject to testing. That is different from a confirmed date, but it does not establish that no other conversation or document exists.
- 05 **Beth:** I may have a presentation from the earlier meeting. I will send it through the customer support channel.
- 06 **Idris:** Please do. We will preserve that ³ _____ alongside the note and review the full context. I do not want either of us to rely on a selective quotation or an incomplete sequence.
- 07 **Beth:** We have spent time preparing for this. I also want a credit, not just another explanation of your process.
- 08 **Idris:** I can record the ⁴ _____ and its basis for the authorized reviewer. I cannot approve a credit or promise the result, but your reported impact belongs in the review.
- 09 **Beth:** This is infuriating. Your team has handled it badly, and I want someone senior to take responsibility.
- 10 **Idris:** You can challenge our handling. I will arrange a ⁵ _____ to a manager and identify who owns the review. I remain responsible for making sure you receive the update I promise.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Beth:** You are useless if all you can do is repeat that you cannot commit. Why should I keep talking to you?
- 12 **Idris:** I want to continue helping, and I need to set a ⁶ _____ here: please keep comments focused on the issue rather than personal insults. We can discuss the impact, the records, and the review without directing remarks at each other.
- 13 **Beth:** Fine. My concern is that nobody has taken ownership. What will actually happen next, and when will I hear from you?
- 14 **Idris:** I will confirm the ⁷ _____ and update you by Thursday at fifteen hundred UTC. That update may say the assessment is still pending, but I will not leave you waiting without the promised contact.
- 15 **Beth:** I can accept a status update if you do not present it as the issue being resolved. The date and our preparation costs still need review.
- 16 **Idris:** Agreed. The ⁸ _____ remains open. If personal insults resume, our procedure allows a pause with a clear continuing support route, not deletion of the complaint or abandonment of the review.
- 17 **Beth:** Then summarize what you have understood so I can correct anything before the manager sees it.
- 18 **Idris:** Here is the ⁹ _____: your team relied on an October expectation, incurred preparation effort, and wants the communication history, delivery status, and credit request reviewed. The available note is conditional, and you may provide another record.
- 19 **Beth:** That captures it. I will send the presentation, and I expect the Thursday update even if the answer is not final.
- 20 **Idris:** You will receive it. ¹⁰ _____ starts with follow-through. I will send the summary, confirm the owner, and keep the agreed contact time.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. expectation gap | 2. conditional estimate | 3. supporting evidence | 4. compensation request | 5. complaint escalation | 6. boundary | 7. review owner | 8. resolution path | 9. read-back | 10. Trust repair

Respond to another disputed delivery expectation

F Say it

A note describes a November target subject to testing. Customer Dena requests a confirmed 30 November date and a credit. Manager Vik cannot approve either. He can route additional evidence for review and update Dena on Tuesday at 09:00 UTC.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

08

WORD + PHRASE BANK

conditional target / 09:00 UTC / credit / review

Manager: "The documented timing is a ¹ _____."

Customer: "My additional messages should be sent for ² _____."

Manager: "I cannot approve the requested ³ _____."

Customer: "The next status update is Tuesday at ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. conditional target | 2. review | 3. credit | 4. 09:00 UTC

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Onboarding and Implementation Expectations

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What is the status of the Friday launch?

A. A target whose readiness conditions are not yet confirmed

The target remains conditional because required tasks and people are not yet confirmed.

2. Who owns preparation of the customer data?

A. The customer

The brief assigns data preparation to the customer, separately from supplier import mapping.

3. When is the readiness review?

A. Thursday at 15:00 UTC

The stated review has both a day and an explicit time zone.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which launch statement is accurate?

D. Friday remains a target pending the four agreed readiness conditions.

A desired date cannot substitute for the stated acceptance and preparation conditions.

2. Which ownership statement matches the brief?

D. Customer preparation and supplier mapping are separate responsibilities.

The allocation distinguishes source-data preparation from the supplier's mapping work.

3. What does a training invitation establish?

C. A proposed or scheduled event, not completed training

An invitation concerns scheduling and does not prove attendance, learning, or acceptance.

4. What belongs in the Thursday decision?

A. The actual status of each launch condition and any unresolved dependency

The decision must use readiness evidence and confirmed dependencies rather than activity counts or unsupported dates.

01 Conversation answers

Onboarding and Implementation Expectations

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. target date. Turn 2. Target date identifies the intended timing, while the required launch conditions remain unverified.

2. data preparation. Turn 4. The customer prepares and approves source data; the supplier separately handles the agreed import mapping.

3. data owner. Turn 6. Naming a data owner identifies accountability, but availability and approval still require confirmation.

4. test import. Turn 8. The test import checks the migration before operational use; receiving a file does not establish success.

5. user acceptance. Turn 10. User acceptance checks the agreed workflow against customer needs, separately from technical import completion.

6. training slot. Turn 12. A training slot needs confirmed trainer and participant availability; an invitation alone does not complete training.

7. readiness review. Turn 14. The Thursday review assesses the four conditions; scheduling the review does not satisfy them.

8. open dependency. Turn 16. An unresolved export still blocks the dependent checks even if administrator training is complete.

9. handover. Turn 18. The handover transfers support responsibility and contact details, rather than assuming the project team remains available indefinitely.

10. success plan. Turn 20. The success plan brings outcomes, owners, dependencies, and evidence together for the readiness decision.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. target

Customer: "Monday is still a target."

The launch is not confirmed because a required import check has failed.

2. Farah

Supplier: "Source-data approval belongs to Farah."

The brief assigns source-data approval to Farah, not the supplier mapping lead.

3. test import

Customer: "The incomplete technical condition is the test import."

Training is complete, but the test import has not succeeded.

4. 10:00 UTC

Supplier: "The readiness review is Friday at 10:00 UTC."

The supplied time and zone identify the scheduled review, not automatic launch approval.

02 Briefing and language checks

Adoption Metrics and Health Scores

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. How many licensed users logged in during the period?

A. 100 of 120

The brief reports one hundred distinct logins among one hundred twenty licensed users.

2. Which population is relevant to workflow completion here?

C. The 80 users whose roles require that workflow

The stated eligible group is eighty users, including those who did not complete the workflow.

3. Why is the dashboard green?

D. Its current rule emphasizes logins.

The score reflects its configured rule, not proof of workflow adoption or renewal.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which statement correctly describes workflow use?

C. Thirty of eighty eligible users completed it at least once in thirty days.

The measure counts distinct eligible completers within the stated period, not login activity or habit.

2. What is the workflow completion percentage?

C. 37.5%

Thirty divided by eighty is 0.375, whereas the other bases or complement answer different questions.

3. What should happen before blaming resistance?

A. Verify event definitions and ask where the workflow breaks down.

Measurement checks and customer workflow evidence help distinguish technical, role, and process barriers from assumptions.

4. Which follow-up comparison is sound?

D. Compare the same defined eligible group and period, noting any population changes.

Consistent definitions and explicit population changes are necessary to interpret movement in the rate.

02 Conversation answers

Adoption Metrics and Health Scores

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. health score. Turn 2. The health score reflects a configured rule emphasizing logins, not verified achievement of every customer outcome.

2. login rate. Turn 4. The login rate uses one hundred distinct users over one hundred twenty licensed users, approximately 83.3%.

3. denominator. Turn 6. Eighty is the eligible workflow population; using all licenses would answer a different adoption question.

4. eligible population. Turn 8. The eligible population contains the users whose roles require this workflow, rather than every licensed person.

5. event definition. Turn 10. The event definition establishes what the recorded completion means; opening or starting a request may differ.

6. adoption barrier. Turn 12. An adoption barrier is the obstacle to intended use; the reported approver problem still needs investigation.

7. weighting. Turn 14. Weighting determines each component's influence; changing it should improve relevance rather than merely change the color.

8. Frequency. Turn 16. Frequency describes repeated use within a defined period; one completion does not establish habitual adoption.

9. cohort. Turn 18. A cohort supplies a consistent group for follow-up, with membership changes disclosed rather than hidden.

10. usage gap. Turn 20. The usage gap is a difference between expected and observed use, not proof of an inevitable cancellation.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. 75%

Customer: "The login rate is 75%."

Forty-five divided by sixty is 0.75, using all licensed users as the base.

2. 40

Manager: "The eligible scheduling population is 40."

Forty users need the workflow, so they form the relevant completion denominator.

3. 50%

Customer: "The eligible completion rate is 50%."

Twenty divided by forty is one half, not twenty divided by all licenses.

4. workflow completion

Manager: "A login is not necessarily a workflow completion."

Access and completion are different events and must not be reported as interchangeable outcomes.

03 Briefing and language checks

Support Escalations and Incident Communication

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What is the confirmed impact?

C. Scheduled exports fail for eight confirmed EU-region accounts.

The brief limits confirmed impact to scheduled exports for eight identified accounts.

2. What does the workaround provide?

B. Administrator manual downloads, without restored scheduling

The verified workaround is a temporary manual route and does not repair automated scheduling.

3. What is confirmed about timing?

B. The next update is at 14:00 UTC.

The communication deadline is confirmed, while the investigation outcome and fix date remain unknown.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which corrected message is accurate?

B. A verified administrator workaround is available; the fix date remains unconfirmed.

The brief confirms a bounded workaround but does not confirm restoration or a permanent-fix date.

2. What should happen at 14:00 UTC if nothing has changed?

B. Send the promised update and state that the investigation continues.

The agreed communication commitment applies even when the technical status is unchanged.

3. Which scope statement avoids overclaiming?

B. Eight accounts are confirmed affected; wider impact is still being checked.

Confirmed cases define current knowledge rather than establishing a complete global boundary.

4. Which statement requires additional verified evidence?

A. No data was lost and no security issue occurred.

The supplied facts establish neither data-loss status nor security conclusions, so those assurances are unsupported.

03 Conversation answers

Support Escalations and Incident Communication

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. permanent fix. Turn 2. No permanent-fix date is confirmed; the proposed message incorrectly converts uncertainty into a promise.

2. workaround. Turn 4. The workaround allows administrator manual downloads but does not correct automated scheduling or establish permanent resolution.

3. confirmed impact. Turn 6. Confirmed impact currently covers scheduled-export failures for eight identified EU-region accounts, not every account or service.

4. scope of impact. Turn 8. The scope must be verified for each claim; export failure alone establishes neither data loss nor its absence.

5. support case. Turn 10. Linking the support case to I42 keeps account-specific reports connected to the coordinated incident response.

6. customer impact. Turn 12. Customer impact describes the blocked business work and helps reviewers assess needs without inventing a resolution promise.

7. update cadence. Turn 14. The agreed cadence requires the promised update even if the investigation has not produced a new finding.

8. ETA. Turn 16. ETA concerns estimated completion of a specified event; the update appointment is not a technical fix estimate.

9. resolution criteria. Turn 18. Resolution criteria determine closure; successful temporary manual access does not establish restoration of scheduled exports.

10. status update. Turn 20. The status update should align verified impact, workaround limits, unknowns, and the confirmed communication time.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. five

Manager: "The known affected-account count is five."

Five is the confirmed count, not proof that no further accounts could be affected.

2. administrator access

Customer: "The temporary route requires administrator access."

The manual route is restricted to administrators under the supplied workaround conditions.

3. unknown

Manager: "The permanent-fix date remains unknown."

No completion date has been confirmed, despite the available temporary route.

4. 11:30 UTC

Customer: "The next update is at 11:30 UTC."

The stated time is a communication commitment rather than a promise of technical completion.

04 Briefing and language checks

QBRs and Business Outcomes

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What change do the time logs show?

C. A 12-hour difference between the two recorded cycles

Forty minus twenty-eight is twelve hours, but the logs cover only the stated cycles.

2. Which input has not been validated?

A. The \$40 hourly valuation

Joel confirms the time logs, while the hourly monetary value remains an assumption.

3. Why is a proven full ROI claim unsupported?

D. Attribution and recurring benefits are unverified, and relevant costs are incomplete.

The evidence leaves causal, recurring-benefit, valuation, and cost gaps that prevent the asserted financial conclusion.

D Language checks / page 36

1. What follows from the stated hourly assumption?

C. Twelve hours at \$40 would be valued at \$480 per cycle.

Multiplication produces a conditional value, not proof of cash savings or exclusive causation.

2. What is required to describe \$5,760 responsibly?

A. State the assumptions of twelve similar monthly cycles and the unvalidated hourly value.

Annualization extends a limited observation and therefore needs explicit frequency, recurrence, and valuation assumptions.

3. Which cost statement is accurate?

C. The \$3,600 subscription is known, but the full cost base is incomplete.

Incomplete cost records prevent a full return calculation without establishing either a positive or negative result.

4. Which review conclusion is strongest?

C. Report the observed operational change and agree a consistent validation plan.

A bounded observation and explicit next evidence preserve useful learning without inventing financial certainty.

04 Conversation answers

QBRs and Business Outcomes

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. observed change.** Turn 2. The logs establish a twelve-hour difference between two cycles, not a proven recurring financial return.
- 2. attribution.** Turn 4. Attribution remains uncertain because other process changes could contribute to the observed time difference.
- 3. hourly valuation.** Turn 6. The forty-dollar hourly valuation is an assumption, not a rate already confirmed by the customer.
- 4. annualization.** Turn 8. Annualization multiplies the conditional cycle value by twelve, assuming similar monthly results rather than demonstrating them.
- 5. released capacity.** Turn 10. Released capacity makes time available for other work without necessarily lowering payroll or cash expenditure.
- 6. cost base.** Turn 12. The cost base is incomplete because known subscription charges exclude unrecorded implementation and training resources.
- 7. value narrative.** Turn 14. A value narrative can report useful operational evidence while clearly separating assumptions and missing financial inputs.
- 8. baseline.** Turn 16. The baseline must use a consistent task and measurement definition so later comparisons remain interpretable.
- 9. outcome owner.** Turn 18. The outcome owner confirms the relevant result; finance and operations can validate different parts of the evidence.
- 10. value realization.** Turn 20. Value realization concerns benefits actually achieved, which must be separated from the book's conditional financial estimates.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. six hours

Customer: "The observed time difference is six hours."

Thirty minus twenty-four gives six hours for the compared cycle, not a proven recurring annual benefit.

2. \$210

Manager: "At the assumed rate, the cycle value would be \$210."

Six multiplied by thirty-five equals two hundred ten, conditional on the unvalidated hourly value.

3. cash savings

Customer: "Unchanged expenditure means this is not verified cash savings."

Time released does not establish a reduction in actual spending.

4. implementation costs

Manager: "A full return calculation still lacks implementation costs."

The missing implementation costs make the relevant cost base incomplete.

05 Briefing and language checks

Renewals and Churn Risk

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What is the renewal date?

D. 12 November

The subscription is scheduled for renewal on 12 November; 8 October is a discovery meeting.

2. What is known about the decision?

D. Neither cancellation nor renewal approval has been received.

The brief leaves the commercial outcome open while identifying information gaps and a stakeholder change.

3. What is the next agreed customer event?

A. A discovery meeting on 8 October at 10:00 UTC

The agreed meeting explores the current position and is not itself an approval or signature.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which internal renewal update is justified?

A. The contact has changed; priorities and decision roles need confirmation; the outcome is open.

The known stakeholder change supports investigation, not a predetermined commercial outcome.

2. What should Rafael ask Ella first?

A. What matters now and who participates in the decision

Open factual discovery establishes the current context without imposing an unsupported interpretation.

3. For starting recurring revenue 100, loss 10, contraction 5, and expansion 20, what is GRR?

B. 85%

Gross retention excludes expansion: one hundred minus ten minus five, divided by one hundred.

4. Using those same figures, what is NRR?

A. 105%

Net retention includes expansion: one hundred minus ten minus five plus twenty, divided by one hundred.

05 Conversation answers

Renewals and Churn Risk

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

- 1. renewal owner.** Turn 2. The renewal owner coordinates the decision process; Ella has not confirmed that this responsibility belongs to her.
- 2. success criteria.** Turn 4. Success criteria need reconfirmation because the reorganization may change which customer outcomes matter most.
- 3. budget owner.** Turn 6. The budget owner controls the relevant funding decision; an operations role or meeting invitation does not establish that authority.
- 4. stakeholder change.** Turn 8. The departure and replacement of the main contact create an information gap, not automatic cancellation or renewal.
- 5. value evidence.** Turn 10. Value evidence should show validated customer results, with uncertain or outdated claims clearly identified.
- 6. risk signal.** Turn 12. A risk signal indicates a possible retention issue but does not establish the customer's final decision.
- 7. procurement route.** Turn 14. The procurement route identifies the actual customer purchasing steps, rather than assuming operations can complete them alone.
- 8. save plan.** Turn 16. A save plan should address an evidenced retention problem; an unexplained discount may miss the actual customer issue.
- 9. renewal forecast.** Turn 18. The renewal forecast must reflect current evidence; a booked meeting is not approval or a guaranteed outcome.
- 10. renewal plan.** Turn 20. The renewal plan records the agreed actions, owners, and dates while preserving unresolved decision questions.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. 20 December

Manager: "The recorded renewal date is 20 December."

The renewal date differs from the earlier needs-review meeting.

2. needs review

Contact: "The fourth of November is a needs review."

The agreed event explores needs and is not a contract signature or approval.

3. unconfirmed

Manager: "The funding decision role remains unconfirmed."

The new contact has not identified the budget owner.

4. open

Contact: "The commercial outcome is still open."

Neither renewal nor cancellation is recorded, so neither conclusion is justified.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Expansion and Upsell Ethics

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. How many existing seats are unassigned?

B. 30

Eighty total licenses minus fifty assigned leaves thirty unassigned seats.

2. How many assigned users have completed onboarding?

D. 35 of 50

The stated completion count is thirty-five among the fifty currently assigned users.

3. What must happen before using existing unassigned seats?

B. The customer license owner must confirm entitlement and allocation.

The brief makes license-owner confirmation a prerequisite without assuming a new purchase is necessary.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which response best fits the request?

C. Confirm needs and allocation rights before deciding whether additional licenses are necessary.

The relevant decision depends on entitlement, customer need, and readiness, not an automatic sale or blanket refusal.

2. If 25 existing unassigned seats are authorized for the new team, how many remain?

B. 5

Thirty unassigned seats minus twenty-five allocated seats leaves five.

3. What is the stated onboarding completion rate among assigned users?

A. 70%

Thirty-five divided by fifty equals seventy percent; dividing by all eighty licenses uses a different denominator.

4. Which proposal would be transparent?

D. A justified quantity with term, charges, allocation basis, and approval status

A transparent commercial option explains its basis and terms rather than concealing need, permissions, or status.

06 Conversation answers

Expansion and Upsell Ethics

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. unassigned seats.** Turn 2. Thirty unassigned seats exist, but their allocation still depends on the customer's confirmed licensing rights and process.
- 2. entitlement.** Turn 4. Entitlement defines permitted use under the agreement; a visible unassigned count alone does not establish permission.
- 3. allocation.** Turn 6. Authorized allocation of twenty-five from thirty unassigned seats would leave five, without increasing total licenses.
- 4. onboarding completion.** Turn 8. Thirty-five of fifty assigned users completed onboarding, leaving fifteen whose preparation is not complete.
- 5. readiness gap.** Turn 10. Unconfirmed training attendance and ownership are readiness gaps even if enough valid licenses are available.
- 6. incremental demand.** Turn 12. Incremental demand is the additional need beyond usable existing rights, not simply the number of newly interested users.
- 7. fit assessment.** Turn 14. The fit assessment checks the new team's actual workflow and access needs before recommending a purchase or rollout.
- 8. named-user licenses.** Turn 16. Named-user licenses apply to identified individuals under their terms and must not be treated as shared-login permission.
- 9. commercial option.** Turn 18. A commercial option should state the justified quantity, term, charges, and status rather than conceal assumptions.
- 10. Expansion readiness.** Turn 20. Expansion readiness combines usable rights, workflow fit, and practical preparation; it is not established by a purchase request alone.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. 30

Manager: "The unassigned count is 30."

One hundred total licenses minus seventy assigned leaves thirty unassigned.

2. ten

Customer: "If twenty existing seats are authorized, ten remain."

Thirty minus twenty leaves ten, conditional on approved allocation.

3. 70%

Manager: "Onboarding completion among assigned users is 70%."

Forty-nine divided by seventy is seventy percent, using assigned users as the denominator.

4. entitlement

Customer: "Before allocation, we must confirm entitlement."

A spare count does not itself establish permitted use for the new team.

07 Briefing and language checks

Product Feedback and Feature Requests

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What problem has the customer reported?

D. Repeated navigation between similar approval requests

The brief identifies repetitive navigation, while retaining separate authorized decisions remains a requirement.

2. What record must an interim approach preserve?

A. A separate authorized decision for each request

The customer explicitly requires an individual authorized decision record for every request.

3. What does logging the feature request establish?

A. That the need has been recorded for assessment

Recording feedback does not itself determine priority, feasibility, or release timing.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which problem statement best represents the case?

A. Repeated navigation slows similar-request review while individual decisions must remain traceable.

The statement captures the reported effort and preserves the explicit decision-record constraint.

2. Which interim statement is responsible?

D. A saved view may help navigation, subject to verified filters and permissions.

The known capability is a view, not bulk approval or permission to remove required controls.

3. What should the product handoff include?

A. The workflow, frequency, impact, constraints, and representative approved examples

A concrete, appropriately shared problem record supports assessment without unsupported commitments or excessive data.

4. Which customer update correctly describes backlog status?

D. The request is recorded for assessment; priority and delivery timing are not confirmed.

Recorded work remains distinct from prioritization, implementation, testing, and actual release.

07 Conversation answers

Product Feedback and Feature Requests

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. feature request. Turn 2. The proposed bulk-approval button is a feature request, not yet an agreed solution or delivery commitment.

2. problem statement. Turn 4. The reported problem is repeated navigation during review, while exception handling and individual decisions remain necessary.

3. audit trail. Turn 6. The audit trail must retain a separate authorized decision for each request, including routine requests.

4. saved view. Turn 8. A saved view can organize selected records, but it does not create or confirm a bulk-approval capability.

5. acceptance criteria. Turn 10. Acceptance criteria specify what a useful approach must achieve while preserving exception visibility and authorization boundaries.

6. use case. Turn 12. The use case describes the actual approver task, sequence, and context without requiring the customer to design the product.

7. impact statement. Turn 14. The impact statement explains the navigation burden without falsely claiming that the customer wants approval judgment removed.

8. product backlog. Turn 16. A backlog records potential work; entry does not establish delivery priority or a release commitment.

9. Prioritization. Turn 18. Prioritization considers relative value and constraints rather than guaranteeing delivery order from submission date alone.

10. feedback loop. Turn 20. Closing the feedback loop returns the assessment to the customer, including alternatives or unchanged status rather than silence.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. repeated navigation

Customer: "The reported obstacle is repeated navigation."

The stated problem concerns moving between tickets, not permission to remove closure decisions.

2. authorized closure record

Manager: "Each ticket must retain an authorized closure record."

The required record remains a constraint for any interim or future approach.

3. saved queue view

Customer: "The existing capability is a saved queue view."

A view organizes tickets but does not establish batch-closure functionality.

4. not scheduled

Manager: "The release status for batch closure is not scheduled."

No confirmed delivery schedule is supplied, so logging interest cannot become a release promise.

08 Briefing and language checks

Difficult Customers and Boundary Setting

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What does the available 17 September note say?

A. Late October is a target subject to testing.

The note records conditional planning language, not the confirmed date the customer requests.

2. What can Idris commit to?

A. A status update by Thursday at 15:00 UTC

Idris controls the stated communication step, while delivery, compensation, and the full history remain unresolved.

3. What should happen if other evidence exists?

D. Preserve and review it through the appropriate process.

Additional records may matter and should be reviewed without changing history or assuming new authority.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which response addresses the disputed promise accurately?

A. The available note is conditional; let us review any other records you relied on.

The response distinguishes the available wording from the incomplete history without inventing certainty in either direction.

2. Which statement preserves a useful communication commitment?

C. I will update you by Thursday at 15:00 UTC, even if review is still pending.

Idris can commit to communication without promising a delivery or compensation outcome outside his authority.

3. Which behavior alone does not justify treating the customer as abusive?

D. Firmly disputing the record and requesting accountability

Direct criticism and a substantive complaint are not equivalent to personal abuse.

4. If the stated procedure requires a pause, what should Idris preserve?

A. A clear support route, complaint record, owner, and next contact

A conduct pause should not remove appropriate support or prevent review of the underlying concern.

08 Conversation answers

Difficult Customers and Boundary Setting

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. expectation gap.** Turn 2. The expectation gap concerns the October timing Beth relied on versus the conditional status currently documented.
- 2. conditional estimate.** Turn 4. The note targets late October subject to testing, which is conditional rather than a confirmed release date.
- 3. supporting evidence.** Turn 6. Additional messages or presentations may clarify the history and should be preserved for review rather than dismissed.
- 4. compensation request.** Turn 8. Idris can route the requested credit for review but does not hold authority to approve compensation.
- 5. complaint escalation.** Turn 10. Complaint escalation sends the substantive concern to an appropriate reviewer; direct criticism is not itself abusive conduct.
- 6. boundary.** Turn 12. The boundary addresses personal insults while keeping the customer's underlying complaint and right to challenge the service intact.
- 7. review owner.** Turn 14. The review owner coordinates assessment of the records and request; identifying that person does not predetermine the result.
- 8. resolution path.** Turn 16. The resolution path covers assessment and follow-up; a scheduled status message is not a completed remedy or release commitment.
- 9. read-back.** Turn 18. The read-back checks the concern, impact, disputed evidence, and requested review with the customer before the handoff.
- 10. Trust repair.** Turn 20. Trust repair depends on accurate review and reliable follow-through, not an unsupported promise made to end tension.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. conditional target

Manager: "The documented timing is a conditional target."

The testing qualification prevents the available note from establishing an unconditional date.

2. review

Customer: "My additional messages should be sent for review."

Further records may clarify the history and should not be dismissed or treated as automatic approval.

3. credit

Manager: "I cannot approve the requested credit."

Vik lacks compensation authority even though he can record and route the request.

4. 09:00 UTC

Customer: "The next status update is Tuesday at 09:00 UTC."

The stated appointment is for communication, not a guaranteed delivery or compensation decision.

08

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Onboarding and Implementation Expectations

Confirm the objective: Which workflow must the team be able to complete on launch day?

Separate responsibilities: Your team prepares the data; our team maps the agreed fields.

Clarify attendance: Who will attend the administrator training?

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Adoption Metrics and Health Scores

Acknowledge the signal: The login count shows broad access during this period.

Specify the population: Eighty users have roles that require this workflow.

Avoid double counting: Count distinct users, not every repeated login.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Support Escalations and Incident Communication

Acknowledge the impact: I understand that the missing reports are interrupting your daily review.

Explain the workaround: Administrators can use the verified manual download route.

Separate two events: Fourteen hundred UTC is the next update time, not a fix deadline.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 QBRs and Business Outcomes

Acknowledge the correction: You are right to distinguish the time logs from a proven financial return.

Limit the inference: The comparison does not isolate the product's contribution.

Qualify annualization: The annual estimate assumes the same benefit in twelve monthly cycles.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Renewals and Churn Risk

Acknowledge the transition: I understand that responsibilities have changed since our last review.

Ask about the present: Which outcomes matter most during the reorganization?

Check funding separately: Who owns the relevant budget?

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Expansion and Upsell Ethics

Explore the request: What work will the twenty-five new users need to complete?

Avoid an automatic sale: The request does not yet establish a need for twenty-five additional licenses.

Avoid a false equivalence: Training completion does not prove regular workflow use.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Product Feedback and Feature Requests

Respect the idea: I understand why a bulk-approval button sounds useful.

Quantify frequency: About how many requests follow this pattern each week?

Avoid premature advice: We need to verify the filter and permissions before recommending that approach.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Difficult Customers and Boundary Setting

Acknowledge the effect: I understand that your team planned around an October expectation.

Keep the record qualified: I have not yet reviewed every relevant communication.

Set the next update: I will update you by Thursday at fifteen hundred UTC.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance criteria	define acceptance criteria	60
acceptance criterion	agree acceptance criteria	6
acknowledgment	give a clear acknowledgment	68
active user	define active users	14
administrator	train administrators	6
adoption	assess adoption	14
adoption barrier	identify adoption barriers	15
affected account	identify affected accounts	23
allocation	approve license allocation	50
annualization	disclose annualization assumptions	32
ARR	verify ARR	42
assigned seat	review assigned seats	50
attribution	qualify attribution	32
audit trail	preserve the audit trail	59
authorization	verify authorization	59
baseline	establish a baseline	32
benefit estimate	qualify the benefit estimate	32
boundary	set a respectful boundary	69
breadth of adoption	assess adoption breadth	14
budget owner	confirm the budget owner	41
bulk action	assess bulk-action needs	59
business outcome	validate business outcomes	32
cash saving	verify cash savings	32
champion	verify the champion relationship	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

churn risk assess churn risk	41
co-termination discuss co-termination	51
cohort compare user cohorts	14
commercial authority confirm commercial authority	69
commercial option compare commercial options	51
comparison period align comparison periods	32
compensation request route a compensation request	69
complaint escalation arrange complaint escalation	68
concurrent-user license distinguish concurrent-user licensing	50
conditional estimate explain a conditional estimate	68
confirmed commitment verify a confirmed commitment	68
confirmed impact state confirmed impact	23
confounding factor identify confounding factors	33
contemporaneous note preserve contemporaneous notes	68
continuity of support preserve continuity of support	69
contraction identify contraction risk	41
cost base define the cost base	33
cross-sell assess cross-sell fit	50
customer benefit establish customer benefit	51
customer impact describe customer impact	24
cutover plan the cutover	6
data mapping validate data mapping	5
data migration coordinate data migration	5
data owner confirm the data owner	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

de-escalation use de-escalation language	69
delivery status verify delivery status	68
denominator state the denominator	14
dependency identify dependencies	5
depth of adoption assess adoption depth	14
discovery support product discovery	60
disputed record reconcile a disputed record	68
eligible population define the eligible population	14
engagement assess stakeholder engagement	15
entitlement confirm entitlement	50
escalation escalate the case	23
ETA qualify an ETA	24
event definition verify event definitions	15
exception handling preserve exception handling	59
executive sponsor reestablish executive sponsorship	41
expansion assess an expansion opportunity	50
expansion readiness assess expansion readiness	51
expectation gap address the expectation gap	68
factual chronology compile a factual chronology	69
feasibility assess feasibility	60
feature request capture a feature request	59
feedback loop close the feedback loop	60
filter validate the filter	59
fit assessment conduct a fit assessment	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

follow-through demonstrate follow-through	69
frequency measure usage frequency	14
frequency quantify task frequency	60
friction point identify friction points	59
go-live confirm go-live readiness	5
GRR calculate GRR	42
handover complete the handover	6
health score interpret the health score	15
hourly valuation validate the hourly valuation	32
hypercare define hypercare coverage	6
impact statement verify the impact statement	60
implementation plan the implementation	5
implementation cost capture implementation costs	33
incident coordinate an incident	23
incident owner identify the incident owner	23
incremental demand establish incremental demand	51
instrumentation check instrumentation	15
interim approach assess an interim approach	59
kickoff run a kickoff	5
known limitation disclose known limitations	24
lagging indicator distinguish lagging indicators	15
leading indicator test leading indicators	15
license owner consult the license owner	50
license utilization define license utilization	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

licensed user	count licensed users	14
login rate	calculate the login rate	14
logo churn	measure logo churn	41
mitigation	apply an approved mitigation	24
named-user license	verify named-user licenses	50
net benefit	calculate net benefit	33
notice provision	review notice provisions	42
NRR	calculate NRR	42
observed change	report observed change	32
onboarding	coordinate onboarding	5
onboarding completion	verify onboarding completion	51
open dependency	track open dependencies	6
order form	review the order form	51
outcome owner	name the outcome owner	33
pause	explain a call pause	69
permanent fix	validate a permanent fix	23
personal insult	address personal insults	69
post-incident review	schedule a post-incident review	24
prerequisite	verify prerequisites	5
prioritization	explain prioritization	60
priority	confirm the response priority	23
problem statement	refine the problem statement	59
procurement route	verify the procurement route	42
product backlog	review the product backlog	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

proration explain proration	51
QBR prepare a QBR	32
qualification preserve the qualification	68
RACI clarify the RACI	6
read-back give a closing read-back	69
readiness gap address readiness gaps	51
readiness review hold a readiness review	6
released capacity describe released capacity	32
renewal coordinate a renewal	41
renewal date verify the renewal date	41
renewal forecast update the renewal forecast	42
renewal owner identify the renewal owner	41
renewal plan maintain the renewal plan	42
reorganization understand reorganization effects	41
representative example select representative examples	60
reproduction reproduce the issue	23
reproduction steps provide reproduction steps	60
resolution criterion confirm resolution criteria	24
resolution path explain the resolution path	69
restoration confirm service restoration	24
retention improve customer retention	42
revenue churn distinguish revenue churn	41
review owner identify the review owner	68
risk signal record a risk signal	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

roadmap qualify roadmap information	60
ROI substantiate ROI	33
rollback plan review the rollback plan	6
root cause verify the root cause	24
save plan agree a save plan	42
saved view configure a saved view	59
scheduled export restore scheduled exports	23
scope of impact verify the scope of impact	24
seat count available seats	50
sensitivity analysis test assumption sensitivity	33
sentiment record customer sentiment	15
service recovery coordinate service recovery	68
severity assess incident severity	23
shelfware investigate shelfware	51
source export approve the source export	5
stakeholder change track stakeholder changes	41
status update issue a status update	24
subscription cost confirm subscription costs	33
success criterion reconfirm success criteria	42
success plan agree a success plan	5
support case link the support case	23
supporting evidence request supporting evidence	68
target date qualify the target date	5
test import complete a test import	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

time saving	validate time savings	32
training cost	include training costs	33
training slot	confirm the training slot	6
true-up	review true-up terms	51
trust repair	support trust repair	69
UAT	schedule UAT	6
unassigned seat	verify unassigned seats	50
unique user	count unique users	14
update cadence	maintain the update cadence	24
upsell	justify an upsell	50
usage gap	investigate the usage gap	15
usage telemetry	validate usage telemetry	15
use case	document the use case	59
user story	refine a user story	60
UTC	specify the time in UTC	24
validation	obtain customer validation	33
value evidence	refresh value evidence	42
value narrative	build a credible value narrative	33
value realization	track value realization	33
vanity metric	question a vanity metric	15
weighting	review score weighting	15
workaround	provide a verified workaround	23
workflow	map the workflow	59
workflow completion	measure workflow completion	14

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] Gainsight. How Gainsight Redesigned the Customer Health Score for One of Its Products (2021).

[Open the original source](#)

Background on multidimensional account health. The book uses original fictional metrics, not a reproduction or endorsement of a proprietary scoring framework. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] Pendo. The Path to Increasing Product Adoption.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on usage, adoption, and retention terminology. All populations, calculations, and customer outcomes in the exercises are invented. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] Atlassian. Incident Communication Best Practices.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on communicating verified impact, status, and update timing. The incident and its approved workaround are fictional. Checked 1 October 2026.

[4] Atlassian. Agile Roadmaps: Build, Share, Use, and Evolve.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on communicating evolving product plans. Roadmap examples do not determine contractual obligations or promise real product availability. Checked 1 October 2026.

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